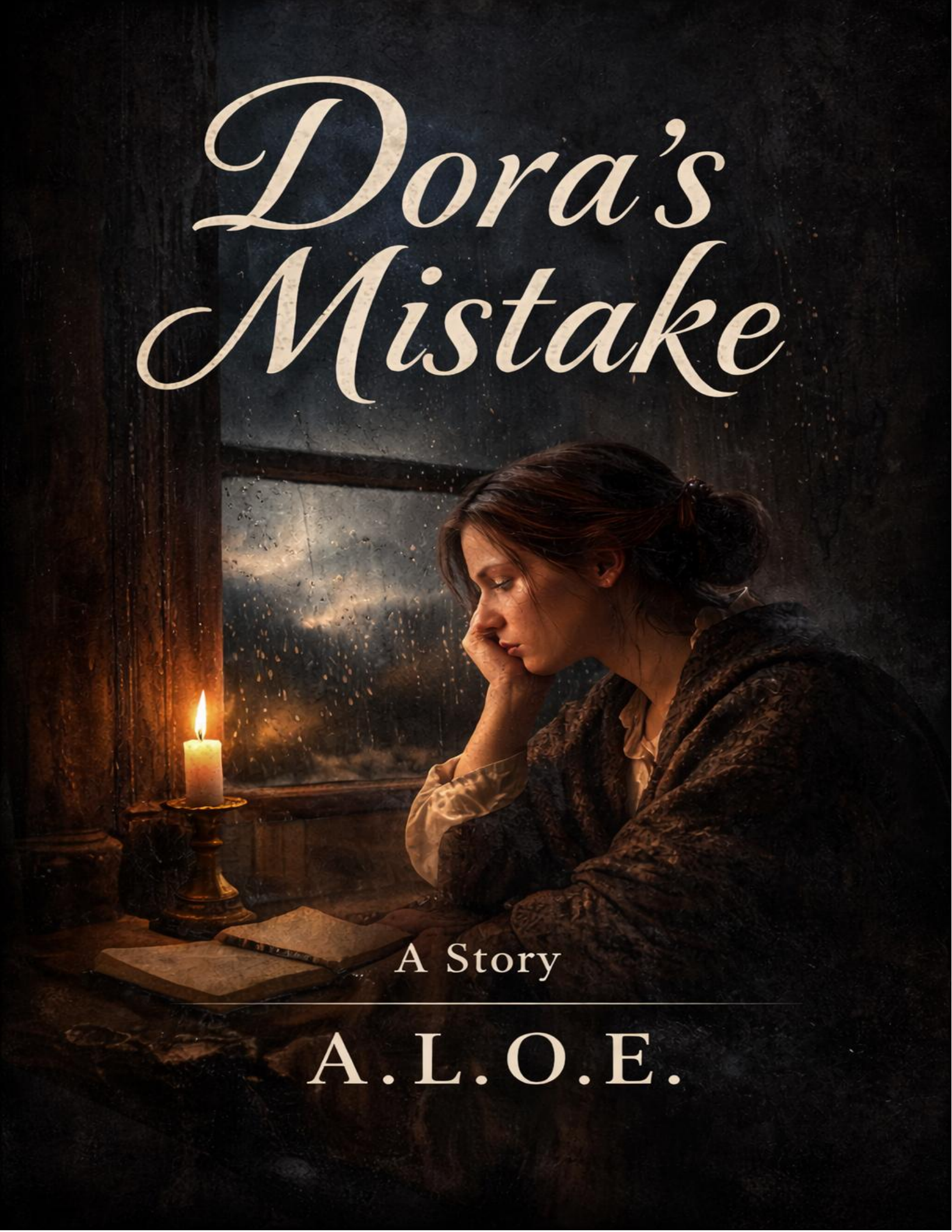
Dora's Mistake



A Story

A.L.O.E.

The InfiniDigital eBook of Dora's mistake

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DORA SEATED HERSELF NEAR THE SIDE TABLE. [Page 58.

DORA SEATED HERSELF NEAR THE SIDE TABLE.

DORA'S MISTAKE

A Story

BY

A.L.O.E.

Author of "The Lost Jewel," "The Young Pilgrim," etc. etc.

London

JOHN F. SHAW & CO.

48 PATERNOSTER ROW

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Dora's Mistake

CHAPTER I

WANTING WORK

"YOU have no right to spoil my desk, you tiresome, mischievous boy!"

"I've not spoilt it, Agnes; I've only ornamented it by carving that little pattern all round."

"I don't call that carving, nor ornamenting either!" cried Agnes, in an angry voice. "You've nicked it all round with your knife; you've spoilt my nice little desk, and I'll—"

What threat Agnes might have added remains unknown, for her sentence was broken by a violent fit of coughing, whoop after whoop—a fit partly brought on by her passion.

"What is all this, my children?" asked Mrs. Temple, drawn into the room called the study by the noise of the quarrel between her son and her eldest daughter.

Lucius, a boy more than twelve years of age, and therefore a great deal too old to have made so foolish a use of his knife, stood with a vexed expression on his face, looking at his poor sister, who, in the violence of her distressing cough, had to grasp the table to keep herself from falling. Amy, her younger sister, had run to support her; while Dora and little Elsie, who had both the same complaint, though in a milder form than their sister, coughed with her in chorus.

Mrs. Temple's care was first directed to helping her poor sick daughter. Agnes, as well as her three sisters, had caught the whooping-cough from their brother Lucius, who had brought it from school.

It was several minutes before the room was quiet enough for conversation. But when Agnes, flushed and trembling, with her eyes red and tearful from coughing, had sunk on an arm chair relieved for a time, Mrs. Temple was able to turn her attention to what had been the cause of dispute. A rosewood desk lay on the table, and round the upper edge of this desk Lucius had carved a little pattern with the large sharp knife which he held in his hand.

"I am sure, mamma, that I did not mean to do mischief," said Lucius, "nor to vex Agnes either. I thought that a carved desk would be prettier than a plain one, and so—"

"You might have tried the carving on your own desk," said Agnes faintly. The tears were rolling down her cheeks,

and she dared not raise her voice lest she should bring on the whooping again.

"So I might, blockhead that I am; I never thought of that!" exclaimed Lucius. "But if you like we will exchange desks now, and then all will be right. Mine is a bigger desk than yours, and has not 'many' ink-stains upon it."

The proposal set Dora, Amy, and Elsie laughing, and a smile rose even to the lips of Agnes. She saw that Lucius was anxious to make up for his folly; but the big school desk would have been a poor exchange for her own, which was neat and had red velvet lining; while hers, being scarcely larger than a workbox, would have been of little service to Lucius at school.

"Oh, no! I'll keep my own desk; the carving does not look so very bad, after all," murmured Agnes, who had an affectionate heart, though by no means a perfect temper.

"I took no end of pains with it," said Lucius, "and my knife is so sharp that—"

"I would rather that you did not try its edge on my table," cried his mother, barely in time to save her mahogany from being "ornamented" as well as the desk.

"Stupid that I am! I was not thinking of what I was about!" exclaimed Lucius, shutting up the knife with a sharp click. "But the truth is, I'm so horribly sick of having nothing to do that I must set about something. I don't like reading, I've enough and too much of that at school; you won't let me go out, lest the damp should bring back my coughing and whooping—I've had enough and too much of that also; I've only the girls to play with, for none of my

own friends must come near the house because of this tiresome infection; and I shall be taking to cutting my own fingers off some day for want of something better to do!"

"It's a case of idleness being the mother of mischief," cried the bright-eyed Dora, who was busy embroidering with many coloured silks an apron for little Elsie's doll.

"Idleness is indeed very often the mother of mischief," observed Mrs. Temple. "I am afraid that you all have often proved the truth of the proverb."

"Perhaps it was partly idleness that made the children of Israel do so very, very wrong when they were wandering about in the desert," observed Amy, glancing up from a book on the subject which she had been reading.

"Ah! They were shut up in the wilderness mouth after month, year after year," cried Lucius, "after they had come forth from Egypt with their flocks and herds and all kinds of spoil. They had little to do, I suppose, and may have grown just as tired of the sameness of their lives as I have of the dulness of mine."

"I have often thought," observed Mrs. Temple, who had seated herself at the table and taken up her knitting—"I have often thought how tenderly the Lord dealt with His people in providing for them pleasant, interesting occupation when He bade them make the Tabernacle, and condescended to give them minute directions how it should be made. There were the various employments of carving, ornamenting, working in metal, to engage the attention of the men; while the women had spinning, weaving, sewing, and embroidering, with the delightful assurance that the

offering of their gold and silver, their time and their toil, was made to the Lord and accepted by Him."

THE WILDERNESS JOURNEY OF THE CHILDREN OF ISRAEL.

THE WILDERNESS JOURNEY OF THE CHILDREN OF ISRAEL.

"I never before thought of the making of the Tabernacle being a 'pleasure' to the Israelites," observed Agnes. "I always wondered at so many chapters in the Bible being filled with descriptions of curtains, silver loops, and gold ornaments, which are of no interest at all to us now."

"My dear, it is our ignorance which makes us think any part of the Bible of no interest," observed Mrs. Temple. "If you remember the readiness with which, as we know, the Israelites brought their precious things for the Tabernacle, and if you can realize the eager pleasure with which, after the long idleness which had ended in grievous sin, men and women set to work, you will feel that the order to make a

beautiful place for worship must have been the opening of a spring of new delight to the children of Israel. They had the Lord's own pattern to work from, so there was no room for disputes about form or style; and it was a pattern admirably suited to give pleasant employment to numbers of people, and to women as well as to men. Fancy how listless languor must have been suddenly changed to animation; the murmurs of discontented idlers to the hum of cheerful workers; and how vanity and foolish gossip amongst the girls must have been checked while they traced out their rich patterns and plied their needles; and instead of decking their own persons, gave their gold and jewels freely to
God!"

"I wish that we'd a Tabernacle to make here," exclaimed Lucius, whose restless fingers had again opened his dangerous plaything.

Mrs. Temple raised her hand to her brow: a thought had just occurred to her mind. "We might possibly manage to make a model of the Tabernacle," she said, after a moment's reflection.

"Ah, yes! I'd do all the carving part—all the hard part," cried Lucius eagerly.

"Do, do let us make a model!" exclaimed his sisters.

"It would be a long work—a difficult work; I am not sure whether we could succeed in accomplishing it," said Mrs. Temple. "And after all our labour, if we did manage to make a fair model, to what use could we put it? We had better consider all these matters before we begin what must be a tedious and might prove an unprofitable work."

"Ah, a model would be of great use, mamma!" cried Dora. "At Christmas-time, when this tiresome infection is over, and we go to our aunt at Chester, we could show it to all her friends."

"And to her school children—her Ragged School children!" interrupted Lucius, with animation. "We've let them see our magic-lantern for three Christmases running, and if the children are not tired of the slides of lions, bears, and peacocks, I'm sure that I am; besides, I smashed half the slides by accident last winter. A model of the Tabernacle would be something quite new to please the ragged scholars, and Aunt Theodora would draw so many good lessons from it."

"And could we not do with the model what we did with the magic-lantern," suggested Dora, "make of it a little exhibition, letting aunt's friends come and see it for sixpenny tickets, and so collect a little money to help on the Ragged School?"

"That would be so nice!" cried Amy.

"That would be famous!" exclaimed little blue-eyed Elsie, clapping her hands.

"Let's set to work this minute!" said Lucius, and he rapped the table with his knife.

Dora threw the doll's apron into her workbox, eager to have some employment more worthy of the clever fingers of a young lady of more than eleven years of age.

Mrs. Temple smiled at the impetuosity of her children. "I must repeat, let us consider first," she said. "Possibly not one amongst you has any idea of the amount of labour and

patience required to complete a model of the Tabernacle which was made by the children of Israel."

"Of course our Tabernacle would be much smaller than the real one was," remarked Dora.

"Supposing that we made it on the scale of one inch to two cubits, I wonder what its length would be," said Mrs. Temple. "Just bring me the Bible, Lucius. I will turn over to the description of the Tabernacle, which we will find in the Book of Exodus."

"I do not know what a cubit is," said little Elsie, while her brother ran for the Bible.

"Don't you remember what mamma told us when we were reading about the size of the Ark?" said Agnes. "A cubit is the length of a man's arm from the elbow to the end of his middle finger, just about half of one of our yards."

"Eighteen inches, or, as some think, twenty," observed Mrs. Temple, as she opened the Bible which Lucius had just placed on the table before her.

"Let's count a cubit as exactly half a yard, mamma," said Lucius, "and then one inch's length in the model would go for a yard's length in the real Tabernacle. If we reckon thus, how long would our model need to be?"

"The outer court of the Tabernacle was one hundred cubits long by fifty broad," replied Mrs. Temple; "that, in such a model as we propose making, would be a length of four feet and two inches, by a breadth of two feet and one inch."

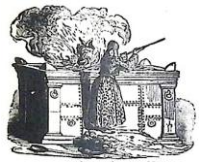
"Just large enough to stand comfortably on this side table!" cried Lucius. "There will be room enough on this table, and I'll clear it of the books, workbox, and flower jar in a twinkling."

"Stop a minute, my boy!" laughed his mother, as Lucius appeared to be on the point of sweeping everything off, including the green cloth cover. "We have not even decided on whether this model should be made at all. And if we do begin one, months may pass before we shall need that table on which to set it up."

"Oh, do, do let us make a model!" again the young Temples cried out.

CHAPTER II

THE TABERNACLE



"I'M ready to undertake every bit of the woodwork," added Lucius, impatient to use his sharp knife on better work than that of spoiling a desk.

"First hear what you will have to undertake," said his more cautious and practical mother. "The mere outer court has sixty pillars."

"Sixty pillars!" re-echoed the five.

"Besides four more pillars for the Tabernacle itself," continued Mrs. Temple, "and forty-eight boards of wood, to be covered all over with gold."

"How large would each board have to be?" asked Lucius.

"Each five inches long, and three quarters of an inch broad," answered his mother.

"And quite thin, I suppose," said the young carpenter, looking thoughtfully at the blade of his knife which was to accomplish such a long, difficult piece of work.

"We could get gold leaf for the gilding, mamma," suggested Dora quickly, "and pasteboard instead of wood; pasteboard would look quite as neat, and need not be cut up into boards."

"Oh, it's not the gilding, nor the cutting up the planks either, whether they be made of pasteboard or wood, that puzzles me!" cried her brother. "But think of sixty-four pillars! How on earth could I cut out so many slender little rods with my knife!"

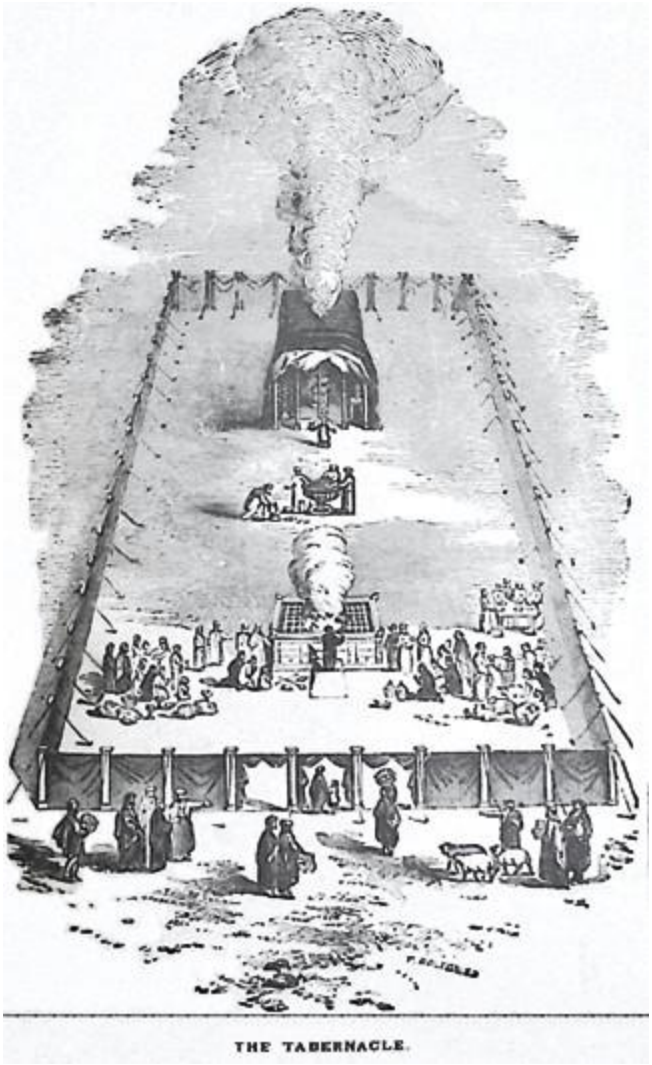
"Thick wire might be used for the pillars just as well as pasteboard for the planks," said Agnes; "when covered with gold leaf, they would look just the same as if—." The sentence was interrupted by another fit of coughing; it was clear that poor Agnes was at present little fitted to join in the conversation.

"There is a picture of the Tabernacle in your Bible, mamma, that will help us in arranging what is to be done; and you will decide on which of us should do each portion of the work," said Dora.

Mrs. Temple turned over the leaves till she came to the picture.

"Here you see a long open court," she observed, "enclosed by pillars supporting curtains of fine linen, fastened to them by loops of silver. I shall supply the linen for these curtains, and I think that my little Amy, who sews so nicely, may make them. This work will require only neatness and patience, and Amy has both."

"Ah, mamma! But the silver loops—how could I make them?" suggested Amy, who had very little self-confidence.



THE TABERNACLE.

"I have a reel of silver thread upstairs in my box," said her mother; "you will make the tiny loops for the curtains of that."

"And I will manage the sixty-four pillars!" cried Lucius. "It was no bad notion to make them of wire. But they must be fixed into something hard, to keep them upright in their places."

"I was thinking of that," said his mother; "we shall need a wooden frame, rather more than four feet by two, to support the model; and into this frame, holes must be drilled to receive the sixty-four wires."

"I must borrow the carpenter's tools," observed Lucius; "I can't do all that with my knife. I see that I have a long, difficult job before me."

"Do you give it up?" cried little Elsie, looking up archly into the face of her brother.

"Not I!" said the schoolboy proudly. "The harder the work, the more glorious is success!"

"What are those objects in the court of the Tabernacle?" asked Amy, who had been thoughtfully examining the picture.

"That large square object, with grating on the top, from which smoke is rising, is the Altar of burnt-offering," said her mother. "Through the grating the ashes of animals that had been slain as sacrifices fell into a cavity below. The projections which you see at the four corners are called the horns of the altar, of which you read in various parts or the Bible."

"Was it not an Altar of burnt-offering that Elijah made on Mount Carmel," asked Dora, "when he cut the dead bullock in pieces and prayed to the Lord till fire was sent down from heaven?"

"Yes," answered her mother, "but that altar was not like the one in the picture. Elijah built his up quickly; it was merely formed of twelve stones. The altar made by the Israelites in the desert was framed of wood, and covered

with brass. It was nearly eight feet square, and was reached, not by steps, but by a sloping bank of earth."

"And what is that very large vase farther on in the picture?" asked Amy.

"That is meant for the Brazen Laver, to hold water for the priests to wash at. This laver was made of brass which the women of Israel offered. Do any of my girls remember what articles had been made before of that brass?"

The party were silent for a few seconds, and then Amy said, with a blush on her cheek, "The mirrors of the women, mamma."

She was rather inclined to be vain of her looks, and her mother, who had noticed how much of her Amy's time was foolishly spent before a glass, had drawn her attention, some days before that of which I write, to a fact which has been thought worthy of mention in the Bible. The women of Israel had the self-denial to give up the brazen mirrors—which were to them what glass mirrors are to us—to form a laver for the use of the priests when engaged in the service of God.

Mrs. Temple smiled pleasantly to see that the example of the women in the desert had not been forgotten by her child.

"Is not that kind of large tent which is standing in the court, the Tabernacle itself?" inquired Dora.

"Yes, it is the Tabernacle," said her mother.

"Why is all that smoke coming out of it?" asked Elsie.

"That smoke in the picture represents the pillar of cloud which guided the Israelites in their wanderings," said Mrs. Temple. "For it is written in the book of Exodus (xl. 38), 'The cloud of the Lord was upon the Tabernacle by day, and fire was upon it by night, in the sight of all the house of
Israel, throughout all their journeys.'"

"What a very holy place that Tabernacle must have been!" said Amy, in a low tone of voice.

"There was not only the pillar of cloud as a visible sign of God's presence resting upon it," observed Mrs. Temple, "but when Moses had finished making the Tabernacle, a miraculous light, called by the Jews 'Shekinah,' and, in the Bible, 'the glory of the Lord,' filled the most holy place."

"I wish that it were so with holy places now!" exclaimed Agnes. "If a cloud always rested on the roofs of our churches, and a glorious light shone inside, people would not be so careless about religion as they are now."

"I fear that no outward sign of God's presence would long prevent carelessness and sin," replied Mrs. Temple.

"What, mamma, not even a shining glory in church!" cried Amy.

"Remember, my child, all the wonders and terrors of Mount Sinai—the thunders and lightnings, the trembling of the earth, and the sound of the trumpet exceeding loud! The Israelites quaked with fear. And yet, in sight of that very Mount Sinai, in sight of the thick cloud resting above it, those Israelites openly broke God's commandments, and fell into grievous sin! The only thing to save us from sinning

against God is for our hearts to be the tabernacle in which He vouchsafes to dwell, and to have His Holy Spirit shining as the bright light within! Can any one of you repeat that most beautiful verse from Isaiah (lvii. 15), which shows us that the Lord deigns to dwell with the lowly in heart?"

Of all Mrs. Temple's family, Agnes had the best memory, though she had neither the quick intelligence of her twin sister Dora, nor so much of the love of her Heavenly Master which made Amy, though younger than herself, more advanced in religious knowledge. Dora had often admired the verse mentioned by her mother, and to the humbleminded little Amy it had brought a feeling of thankful joy: but it was Agnes who remembered it best by heart, so as to be able now to repeat it without making a single mistake.

"'Thus saith the high and lofty One that inhabiteth eternity . . . I dwell in the high and holy place, with him also that is of a contrite and humble spirit, to revive the spirit of the humble, and to revive the heart of the contrite ones.'"

CHAPTER III

THE CURTAINS

"THE girls will have plenty to do in making the curtains for the Tabernacle itself," observed Lucius, who, while his mother and sisters had been conversing, had been engaged in looking over the description in the book of Exodus. "Why, there are four distinct sets of curtains! First, the undermost, ten curtains of fine-twined linen, with blue, and purple, and scarlet, and cherubims of cunning—that must mean skilful—work upon them!"

"How splendid that must be!" exclaimed Elsie.

"Then a covering of goats' hair curtains above these fine embroidered ones," continued Lucius; "then a third of rams' skins dyed red; and then, to complete the whole, a covering of badgers' skin curtains the outermost of all."

The four young workwomen were somewhat startled at the difficulties which their brother's words had raised.

Dora gave a voice to the thoughts of her sisters when she said, with a look of disappointment, "It will be hard to get rams' skins dyed red, but I do not know where goats' hair can be bought in England; and as for badgers' skins, I am afraid that it will be quite impossible even for mamma to find such a thing, unless it be in the British Museum."

"So we must give up making the Tabernacle," said Amy, with a sigh.

"Nay, nay," cried their smiling mother, "we must not be so readily discouraged. Learned men tell us that the Hebrew word translated into 'badgers' skins' in our Bible is one of uncertain meaning which some think denotes a blue colour, and which, if intended for a skin at all, is not likely to have been that of a badger. Blue merino for the outer covering, red Turkey cloth instead of rams' skins, and mohair curtains instead of goats' hair, will do, I think, for our model; as well as the pasteboard, wire, and gold and silver thread, which must represent metal and wood."

"Yes," said Lucius quickly, "they will do a great deal better than the real materials; for if we could manage to get rams' skins or badgers' skins to cut up, such curtains would be a great deal too thick and heavy for a little model like ours. Why, our tabernacle will be only fifteen inches long by five inches in breadth."

All the grave little faces brightened up with smiles at this way of getting over what had seemed a very great difficulty.

Elsie looked especially pleased. Pressing close to her mother, and laying her little hand on Mrs. Temple's arm in a coaxing way, she cried, "Oh, mamma, don't you think that I could make one set of the curtains? You know that I can hem and run a seam, and don't make 'very' large stitches. Might I not try, dear mamma? I should like to help to make the Tabernacle."

It would have been difficult to the mother to have resisted that pleading little face, even had Elsie made a less reasonable request.

"I cannot see why these little fingers should not manage the red Turkey cloth which will stand for the rams' skins," replied Mrs. Temple, stroking the hand of her child; "the outermost covering of all will, of course, need finer stitching, and one of the twins will take that and the mohair besides. To make both these sets of curtains will take far less time, and require less skill than must be given to the embroidery on linen in blue, scarlet, and purple, which will adorn the inner walls and ceilings of our model."

"Do, do let me have the embroidery, it is just the work which I delight in," cried Dora; and she might have added, "excel in," for she was remarkably clever in making things requiring fancy and skill.

Agnes, her twin, flushed very red, not merely from the straining of the cough which had frequently distressed her, but from jealous emotion. Agnes had not a lowly heart, and in her heart, angry feelings were rising at her sister's asking that the finest and most ornamental portion of the work should be given to her.

"Of course mamma will not let you have the beautiful embroidery to do, Dora, and leave the plain mohair and merino to me, her 'eldest' daughter!" exclaimed Agnes, laying a proud stress on the word 'eldest,' though there was but an hour's difference between the ages of the twins.

"Why, Agnes, what nonsense that is!" cried Lucius bluntly. "You know as well as I do that your clumsy fingers can't so much as hem a silk handkerchief neatly, and how would they manage embroidery in purple, scarlet, and blue? Your bad work would spoil the whole thing."

"Don't you meddle; you don't know anything about work!" exclaimed Agnes, in a loud, angry tone, which brought on another severe fit of coughing and whooping.

Mrs. Temple was grieved at the ill-temper shown by her eldest daughter, and all the more so as Agnes was in so suffering a state as to make it difficult for her mother to reprove her as she would have done had she been in health.

Their mother had to wait for some time before the cough was quieted enough for her gentle voice to be heard, though Amy had quickly brought a glass of water to help in stopping the cough. When Agnes could breathe freely again, their mother thus addressed her children:—

"I should be vexed indeed, my dears, if what I proposed as a pleasant and profitable occupation for you all should become a cause of strife, an occasion for foolish pride and contention. The tabernacle was in itself a holy thing, made so by the special appointment and presence of the Lord; I would wish the making of its model to be a kind of holy employment, one never to be marred by jealousy and pride.

"The profits of your labour, if there be any, you mean to devote to helping the poor; therefore I hope that we may consider the work as an offering to the Lord—a very small offering, it is true, but still one which He may deign to accept, if it be made in a lowly, loving spirit; but if selfish, worldly feelings creep in, then good works themselves become evil. The Israelites were expressly forbidden to offer any creature in which there was a blemish or fault, and our offerings are certainly blemished and spoilt if we mix with them jealousy and pride."

Agnes bit her lip and knitted her brow. She was not without both good sense and good feeling, but she had not yet obtained the mastery over her jealous temper.

"I do not see why Dora should be favoured above me," she murmured.

"Dora is not favoured above you," replied her mother gravely. "The simple state of the case is this—different talents are given to different persons. You have a good memory, Dora has a skilful hand. Were the work in question to be the repeating of a chapter by heart, Dora would never expect to be the one chosen to repeat it. Why should pride make you refuse to own that there are some things in which a younger sister may excel you?"

Agnes hesitated, and glanced at her mother. The girl's brow was a little clouded still, and yet there were signs that her pride was giving way.

"I leave the decision to your own good sense and feeling, my dear," said Mrs. Temple. "Judge yourself whether, if your desire be to make a really beautiful model worthy of the good object to which we devote it, it would be better to place the embroidery part in Dora's hands or your own."

"Let Dora do it," said Agnes, with a little effort, her eyes filling with tears; for it was hard to her, as it is to most of us, to wrestle down struggling pride.

Mrs. Temple smiled lovingly upon her daughter. "One of the most precious lessons which we can learn," she said, "is, in obedience to the command of our Lord, to be willing to be last of all, and servant of all. The sacrifice of our pride

and self-will is more pleasing to our God than the most costly gifts can be.

"It is worthy of notice, children, that it was not the outer covering of the Tabernacle, that part which would be seen from every quarter of Israel's camp, that was most beauteous and precious. The richest curtains were those seen far less often, those that had the lowest place in the building. So our Heavenly Father cares far more for what is 'within' than for what is 'without,' and there is no ornament so fair in His eyes as that of a meek and quiet spirit."

"I do not think that the Tabernacle was a grand building, after all," observed Lucius, "though there is so much written about it in the Bible. Why, it was only about forty-five feet by fifteen—not so large as the chapel at the end of the town, and not for one moment to be compared to the cathedral which we went to see last summer."

"There is one thing which you perhaps overlook," said his mother; "when the Tabernacle was raised, the Israelites were a nation of wanderers, and had no fixed habitation. Their Tabernacle was a large, magnificent tent, made to be carried about from place to place by the Levites. Every portion of it was so contrived as to be readily taken to pieces, and then put together again. This could not have been done with a building of very great size."

"Nobody could carry about the great cathedral, or even the little chapel!" cried Elsie. "But they were never meant to be moved, they are fixed quite firm in the ground."

"The size of the Tabernacle was indeed not great," continued Mrs. Temple; "but, besides its being filled with a glory which is never beheld now in any building raised by

man, the treasures lavished on it must have given to it a very splendid appearance. It has been calculated that the gold and silver used in making the Tabernacle must alone have amounted in value to the enormous sum of £185,000!"

Exclamations of surprise were uttered, and Dora remarked, "Why, that would be enough to pay for the building of forty large churches as handsome as the new one which we all admire so much."

CHAPTER IV

PRECIOUS THINGS

"THE new church holds ten times as many people as the Tabernacle could," observed Agnes. "I cannot think how a large nation like the Israelites could find space to meet in such a small place, only about twice the size of this room?"

"The Tabernacle was never intended to be to the Israelites what a church is to us," remarked Mrs. Temple. "In the warm climate of Arabia, the people worshipped in the open air, under the blue canopy of the sky; no building to shelter them was required, such as is needful in England. The men of Israel brought their sacrifices to the court of the Tabernacle, where, as you already know, the Altar of burnt-offering and the Laver were placed."

"But, mamma, what was inside the Tabernacle itself—what was so very carefully kept under those four sets of curtains?" asked Dora.

"The Tabernacle was divided into two rooms by a most magnificent curtain of rich embroidery called the 'Veil,'" replied Mrs. Temple. "The outer room, which was double the size of the inner, was named the 'Holy,' or 'Sanctuary.' In this outer room were kept the splendid golden Candlestick with its seven branches, each supporting a lamp which burned all through the night, and the Table of Shewbread, on which twelve cakes of unleavened bread

were constantly kept—the supply being changed on every Sabbath."

"Ah! I remember, it was that shewbread which was given to David when he was hungry," said Lucius, "though it was meant to be eaten only by priests."

"What other things were in the outer part of the Tabernacle?" asked Agnes.

"There was the Altar of Incense, upon which sweet perfume was daily burned, so that the room was filled with fragrance."

"You have told us, mamma, what was in the first part of the beautiful Tabernacle; but what was in the very innermost part, the little room beyond the Veil?" asked Amy.

"That little room, about fifteen feet square, was called the 'Holy of holies,' and contained the most precious object of all—the special symbol of the presence of the Most High. That object was the Ark, with its cover of pure gold which was called the 'Mercy-seat,' and on which were figures of cherubim, wrought also in gold, with wings outstretched. Over this Mercy-seat, and between the golden cherubim rested the wondrous glory which showed that God was with His people. David, doubtless, referred to this when he wrote in the eightieth Psalm, 'Thou that dwellest between the cherubims, shine forth!'"

"And were not precious things laid up in the Ark?" inquired Agnes. "Were not the tables of stone on which the Commandments were written put into it?"

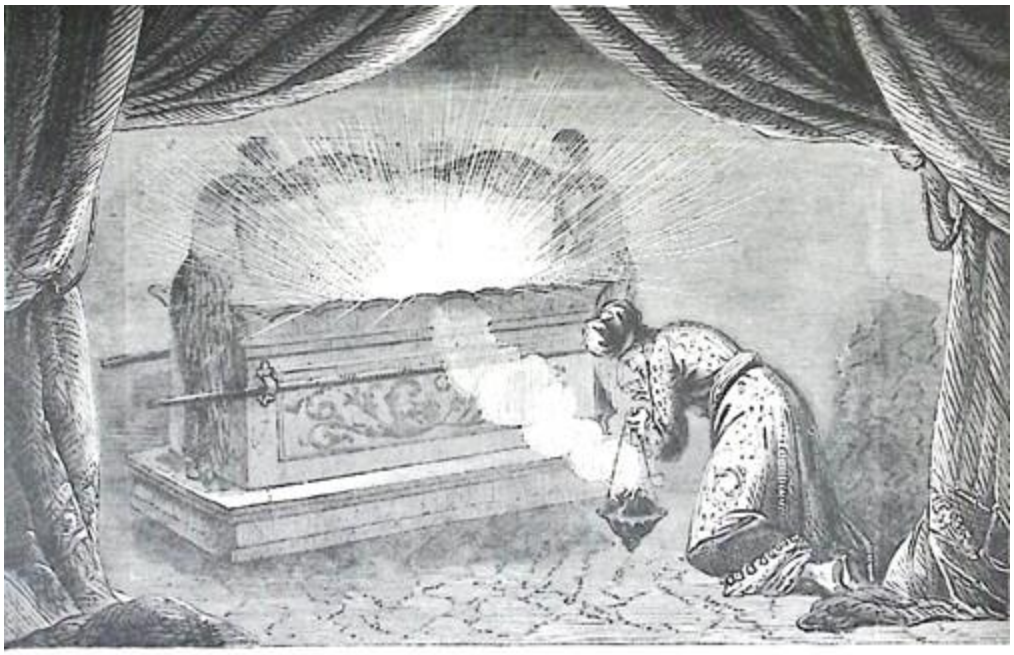
"And the Pot of Manna, kept to remind the people how their fathers were fed in the desert?" said Dora.

"And the wonderful Rod of Aaron that budded and blossomed and bore fruit, was not that also in the Ark?" asked Lucius.

"All these most precious and holy things were laid up in the Ark, beneath the golden cherubim," replied Mrs. Temple.

"Oh, I should have liked above all things to have, seen them!" exclaimed little Elsie. "I should have liked to have lifted up the splendid curtain-veil, and to have gone into the Holy of holies—if the light had not been too dazzlingly bright —and have looked upon all those precious things! Most of all, I'd have liked to see that wonderful Rod of Aaron, if it was the very very same rod that had once been turned into a serpent."

"Ah, my child, none of us would have dared to have lifted that Veil, or to have placed a foot within the Holy of holies!" exclaimed Mrs. Temple. "No mortal was ever suffered to enter that place, most sacred of all, except the High Priest, and that but on one day of the year—the Day of Atonement. Aaron himself, the first High Priest, with trembling awe must have lifted the Veil, and approached the Mercy-seat over which the cherubims spread their wings of gold!"



THE ARK.

THE ARK.

Mrs. Temple spoke in so solemn a tone, as she pointed to the picture of the High Priest kneeling in the Holy of holies, that the children felt that the subject was very sacred, and none of them spoke for several moments. Then Lucius observed, "There is now no place on earth into which no one dare enter, like the Holy of holies in the Tabernacle of old."

"No, my dear, because the Veil has been rent in twain, and the Lord Christ, our great High Priest, has opened a free way for all believers, even into the Holy of holies where God dwells in glory for ever!" said Mrs. Temple, with even greater reverence in her manner, and clasping her hands as she spoke.

"Mamma, I cannot understand you!" cried Amy.

"These are the deep things of God, my dear, and it is very difficult to explain their meaning to children.

"The Tabernacle and the things within it were types, or, as we may call them, pictures of heavenly mysteries, revealed to us by the Gospel. But we will not enter now upon those difficult subjects. I think that you know a little about the appearance of the Tabernacle of which you are anxious to make a model, and also of what was contained within it. To understand the meaning of that holy place, and of its contents, will require much earnest thought and attention. We may perhaps converse a little about it tomorrow, which is Sunday. You will have abundance of time, as the fear of giving infection to others obliges me to keep you from going to church."

CHAPTER V

PREPARATION

"I WISH that to-morrow were any day but Sunday!" exclaimed Lucius. "Just when one is setting about a long work, eager to measure and to make, to cut and to clip, it is vexatious to have to stop in the middle of business, to shove away knife, ruler, pencil, pasteboard, and all, into a drawer for the next twenty-four hours!"

"Perhaps it would be better not to begin the work at all until Monday," mildly suggested his mother.

"Oh no, we've all the Saturday afternoon, let's set to making our model at once!" exclaimed Lucius.

"Please, please, don't make us put off!" cried Dora and Elsie.

Mrs. Temple was a very indulgent mother, and was inclined to be all the more so as every one of her children was either suffering from whooping-cough or just recovering from its effects. She felt sorry at the necessity for shutting out her family from many of their usual occupations and pleasures, and even from the privilege of going to church. She did not, therefore, in the least press the subject of delay, but offered, as soon as early dinner should be over, to go and search in her drawers and boxes for such materials as she might think suitable for the model of the Tabernacle, which her children were so eager to make. The dinner-bell sounded while Mrs. Temple was speaking, and the family went together to the room in which they took all their meals, and gathered round the table, their minds full of the new subject.

While the young Temples are engaged with their dinner, let me introduce them a little more individually to my reader. There, at the bottom of the table, is Lucius, a sunburnt, pleasant-looking schoolboy, with a mass of brown, half-curly locks brushed back from his forehead. He has quick eyes and restless hands, which are seldom perfectly still, even if they have no better occupation than that of tying and untying a morsel of string; but they are now busily plying a large knife and fork, for Lucius is a skilful carver, and the joint of mutton is placed before him, from which to help all the party.

The pale girl seated on the right of Lucius, with eyes weak and reddened by the effect of her cough, is Agnes, the elder of the twins. Her brow is furrowed, perhaps from the same cause, perhaps because she is more irritable in temper than her brother and sisters. But Agnes is a conscientious girl, one who thinks much of duty: and we may hope that "prayer and pains," which it has been well said can do anything, will give her the mastery over faults against which she is trying to struggle.

Opposite to Agnes sits Dora, who, though her twin, is not much like her, being a good deal taller, prettier, and more animated than she. Dora is a much greater favourite with Lucius and the younger girls than the elder twin, from being gay, obliging, and clever. Agnes is perfectly aware that such is the case, and has to pray and strive against the sin of jealousy, which is too ready to creep into her heart and poison all her enjoyments.

On either side of Mrs. Temple are her two younger daughters, Amy and Elsie. The former, with soft brown eyes and long flaxen hair tied with blue ribbons, is strikingly like her mother, who has, at least so think her children, the

sweetest face in the world. Amy has never been known to quarrel or utter an angry word, and is always ready to give help to any one who needs it. It is no wonder that so gentle a girl is beloved. But Amy knows herself to be by no means faultless, and is much on her guard against the silly vanity which a mother's watchful eye has found out to be lurking in the mind of her dear little girl.

Elsie is a merry blue-eyed child, full of life and intelligence, forward—rather too forward for her age. She has for six years held the place of baby in the home of her widowed mother, and her family are rather disposed to indulge her as if she were a baby still. She enters with animation into the amusements of the elder children, and is by no means disposed to be seen and not heard, as Lucius often laughingly tells her that such little people should be.

THE GARDEN OF EDEN.

THE GARDEN OF EDEN.

During dinner the conversation was almost entirely on the subject of the model, and flowed on pleasantly enough, except when interrupted by coughing. But all the children were glad when meal-time was over, and their mother, with

Amy and Elsie skipping before her, went off to hunt over her little stores for such materials as might be found useful.

Lucius employed the time of their absence in exploring the lumber-room for tops of old boxes or other bits of wood that might, when fastened together, do for the groundframe of the model, into which the gilded pillars might be fixed. Dora, with pencil and paper, busied herself in trying to make an embroidery pattern, introducing the figures of cherubim. Agnes, who was too weak for much exertion, and who took less keen interest in the work than did her sisters, lay on the sofa reading a book, until the return of Amy and Elsie, each of whom carried some little treasure in her hands.

"Look, Agnes, look at these shining reels of gold and silver thread!" exclaimed the youngest child with eager delight.

"Gold thread—ah! That's just what I want!" cried Dora, throwing down her pencil.

"And here is mamma's book of gold leaf; there is a little gold sheet between every one of the pages," continued Elsie. "But oh! It is so thin, so very thin, one dare not breathe near, or the gold would all fly away!"

"I thought that gold was a very heavy metal," observed Agnes, looking up from her book.

"But it is beaten out into such extreme fineness that a bit of gold no larger than a pea would gild all these," said Lucius, who had just entered the room with his arm full of pieces of wood.

"See, Agnes, what we have brought for you!" cried Amy. "Here is a beautiful piece of blue merino for the outer curtains (the badger's skin cover, you know), and blue silk with which to sew it; and here is another piece of mohair for the goat's skin cover, so you are supplied directly with everything that you need; is not that nice?"

Agnes did not look so much delighted as her sister expected that she would; perhaps because she was scarcely well enough to take much pleasure in sewing; perhaps because she had still a feeling of mortification at not having been trusted with the embroidery part of the work.

"I hope that you have brought me the fine linen for the beautiful inner curtains, and the veil for the Holy of holies," cried Dora.

"No, mamma cannot find any linen fine enough, unless she were to tear up her handkerchiefs, and that would be a pity," said Amy. "But mamma has promised to buy some linen both for your curtains and for mine that are, you know, to hang all round the open court of the Tabernacle."

"It is very tiresome to have to stop at the beginning for want of fine linen!" exclaimed Dora. "I hope that mamma will go out and buy us plenty at once."

"Ah! Dora, you know that mamma owned this morning that she felt very tired," said Amy, a little reproachfully; "and the shops are a good way off; it is not as if we lived in the town."

"Besides, it is raining," observed Elsie, who was looking out of the window.

"It is merely a little drizzle that would not hurt a fly!" exclaimed Dora. "Mamma never minds a few tiny drops when she puts on her waterproof cloak."

"Mamma never minds anything that has only to do with her own comfort," observed Amy.

"So there is more need that we should mind for her," said Agnes.

"I'm sure that I wish that I could go to the shops myself without troubling any one!" exclaimed the impatient Dora. "If it were not for this stupid tiresome infection, I'd get Lucius to go with me this minute, and would we not return laden with linen, pasteboard, and all sorts of things! But mamma's fear of setting other people coughing and whooping makes her keep us shut up here in prison."

"Mamma is quite right!" exclaimed Lucius. "I say so, though I hate more than you do being boxed up here in the house."

"Mamma is quite right," re-echoed poor Agnes, as soon as she recovered voice after another violent fit of coughing, which almost choked her. "I should not like to give any one else such a dreadful complaint as this."

Mrs. Temple now entered the room, with several things in her hand.

"I have found a nice bit of red Turkey cloth," said she, "so my little Elsie will be able to set to work on her curtains at once."

The child clapped her hands with pleasure, and then scampered off for her little Tunbridge-ware workbox.

"I hope that you have found the linen too, mamma," cried Dora; "I am in a hurry for it, a very great hurry," she added, regardless of an indignant look from Agnes, and a pleading one from Amy.

"I am sorry that I have no suitable linen," replied their mother, "but I intend to go out and buy some."

"Not to-day, not now, it is raining; you are tired," cried several voices; that of Dora was, however, not heard amongst them.

"I have here some pasteboard, though not sufficient for our model, and a bottle of strong gum which will be most useful," said Mrs. Temple, placing on the table what she had brought; "but gilt paper will be needed as well as gold leaf, and of it I have none; I must procure that, and some more pasteboard for my dear boy."

"And plenty of wire, cut into five-inch lengths for the pillars," added Lucius.

"And linen for Amy and me," joined in Dora.

"But please buy nothing till Monday," said Agnes; "the work can wait quite well for a couple of days."

"Yes, yes, do wait till Monday," cried the other children; Dora again being the only exception.

Dora's selfishness was marring her offering, as Agnes's pride had blemished hers. How difficult it is even in the most innocent pleasure, even in the most holy occupation, to keep away every stain of sin! Ever since the sad time when evil entered the beautiful garden of Eden, and Adam and Eve ate of the fruit which God had forbidden them to

taste, pride, selfishness, and unholiness have been natural to the human heart. Even when we most earnestly try to do what we think good works, how much we need to be on our guard lest sin creep in to spoil all!

Dora, though silent, showed so plainly by her looks her extreme impatience to be supplied at once with materials for which she could have so easily waited, that her gentle mother made up her mind to gratify her wish.

Mrs. Temple put on her waterproof cloak, and, tired as she was, went forth on a shopping expedition. It vexed the children to see that the clouds grew darker, and the shower fell more heavily not long after their mother had quitted the house.

"If mamma catches cold or has pain in her face, it is all Dora's fault!" exclaimed Lucius.

"It was so selfish—so silly not to wait," observed Agnes; "just see how the rain is pouring!"

"I love mamma as much as any of you do!" cried Dora, her heart swelling with vexation, so that she could hardly refrain from tears.

"You love yourself better, that's all," remarked Lucius; and his words were more true than polite.

Mrs. Temple returned home very much tired and rather wet, notwithstanding her umbrella and waterproof cloak. And Dora was, after all, disappointed of her wish to have the linen and begin her embroidery work directly. Mrs. Temple had found it difficult to carry home parcels when she had an umbrella to hold up on a windy day, and had also feared the things might get damp if taken through

driving rain. The wire, pasteboard, gold paper, and linen were to be sent home in the evening, and the longed-for parcel did not appear until it was time for the twins to follow their younger sisters to bed.

CHAPTER VI

TYPES

"This is the day when Christ arose
So early from the dead; And
shall I still my eyelids close
And waste my hours in bed!

"This is the day when Jesus broke
The chains of death and hell;
And shall I still wear Satan's yoke
And love my sins so well!"

THIS well-known hymn was on Amy's mind when she awoke on the following day, and it rose from her heart like the sweet incense burnt every morning in the Tabernacle of Israel.

But Dora's thoughts on waking, and for some time afterwards, might be summed up in the words—"Oh, I wish that this day were not Sunday! How tiresome it is, when my beautiful pattern is all ready, not to be able to try it!"

Mrs. Temple did not appear to be much the worse for her shopping in the rain. Her children knew nothing of the aching in her limbs and the pain in her face which she felt, as she bore both quietly and went about her duties as usual. Dora did not trouble herself even to ask if her mother were well. It was not that Dora did not love her, but at that time the mind of the little girl was completely taken up by her embroidery in scarlet, purple, and blue.

As the children might not go to church, Mrs. Temple read and prayed with them at home, suffering none but Lucius to help her, and letting him read but little, for fear of bringing back his cough.

All through the time of prayers, though Dora knelt like the rest of the children, and was as quiet and looked almost as attentive as any, her needlework was running in her mind. If she thought of the happy cherubim, it was not of their crying "Holy, holy, holy!" in heaven, but of the forms of their faces and wings, and how she could best imitate such with her needle.

I will not say that the other children thought about the Tabernacle only as a holy thing described in the Bible from which religious lessons could be learnt,—little plans for sewing, measuring, or making the model would sometimes intrude, even at prayer-time; but Lucius had resolutely locked up his knife, and he and three of his sisters at least tried to give full attention to what their mother was saying when she read and explained the Word of God.

Mrs. Temple purposely chose the ninth chapter of the Epistle to the Hebrews, a very difficult chapter to the young, but one likely specially to interest her children at a time when the subject of the Tabernacle in the wilderness was uppermost in the minds of all. It will be noticed that Dora did not join at all in the conversation which followed the reading.

"Mamma, that chapter comes nearly at the end of the Bible, and is about our Lord and His death," observed Lucius; "and yet it tells us about the Tabernacle, and its ark, and the high priest going into the Holy of holies. Now, what could the Tabernacle in the desert have to do with our Lord and His dying,—that Tabernacle which was made nearly fifteen hundred years before the birth of Christ, and which was no longer of any use after Solomon's temple was built?"

"The Tabernacle, the ark, the high priest, the sacrifices were all TYPES or figures of greater things to come," replied Mrs. Temple. "There was a secret meaning in them all, referring to our Lord, His work, and His death, and the glorious heaven which He was to open to all believers."

"I don't know what a type is," said Elsie.

"It is not clear to me either," observed Amy.

"Unless we quite understand what a type means, we shall lose much of the lesson conveyed by the wanderings of the children of Israel, and the long account of the Tabernacle, what was in it, and what was done there, which we find in the books of Moses," remarked Mrs. Temple.

"It always seemed to me as if that Tabernacle were quite a thing of the past," said Agnes, "and that it belonged only to the Israelites of old. I never could make out why Christian people in England, thousands of years after the Tabernacle had quite disappeared, should care to know anything about it, the ark, or the altar."

AARON BLESSING PEOPLE.

AARON BLESSING PEOPLE.

"But you say that all these things were types," observed Amy. "Now, what is a type, dear mamma?"

"A kind of shadow or picture of something usually greater than itself," replied Mrs. Temple.

"I don't understand," said Elsie, raising her blue eyes gravely to the face of her mother.

"You know, my dear, that before you came to live in this house, when none of the family but myself had seen it, you still had some little knowledge of what it was like."

"Yes, for you brought us little pictures of the house, both of the back and the front," said Agnes.

"We knew that it was a pretty white house, and had a little tower on one side, and that trees were growing in front, and creepers all up it!" cried Elsie.

"Now, I might have described the place to you in writing, but you would not have known its appearance as well as you did from the pictures," observed Mrs. Temple.

"No, from a mere description, I should not have been able to find out the house directly as I did when I walked alone from the station," cried Lucius. "There are several white houses near this, but the remembrance of the pictures made me know in a moment which was the right one."

"Now, my children, just what a picture is to the object which it represents, so is a type to its anti-type; that word means the real thing of which it is a likeness," observed Mrs. Temple.

"I am afraid that I am very stupid in not making out what you mean at once, dear mamma," said Amy; "but if you would explain just one type in the Bible, I think that I might be able to understand it better."

"Let us take, then, the innermost part of the Tabernacle, the Holy of holies," replied Mrs. Temple. "It was a very beautiful place, full of the glory of God, in which no objects were allowed to be but such as were precious and pure; there was the mercy-seat like a throne, and there were the bright cherubim spreading their golden wings. Now, my children, if we compare small things to great things, cannot you of yourselves find out of what this Holy of holies was a picture or type?"

"A type of heaven!" exclaimed several voices at once; but Amy looked distressed, and murmured softly, "I hope not a type of heaven."

"And why not?" asked Lucius quickly.

"Because no one was ever allowed to go into the Holy of holies save one man, and he only once in the year," replied Amy sadly.

"And that 'not without blood,'" said Lucius, pointing to the seventh verse of the chapter which his mother had just been reading.

"Go on reading, Lucius," said his mother.

And Lucius, as desired, went on. "'Not without blood, which he offered for himself and for the errors of the people, the Holy Ghost thus signifying that the way into the holiest of all was not yet made manifest.'"

"Or, in simpler words," said Mrs. Temple, "that the way into heaven was not yet made plain. When Christ, our great High Priest, had gone into heaven, 'neither by the blood of goats and calves, but by His own blood He entered in once into the holy place, having obtained eternal redemption for us.'"

"Then, mother, the high priest must have been a TYPE of the Lord Jesus Christ!" exclaimed Lucius.

"No," interrupted Agnes, "the sacrifice was the type, the sacrifice whose blood had been shed."

"Both high priest and sacrifice were types of our blessed Saviour," replied Mrs. Temple. "The Lord was the victim offered, and He was also the high priest who made the offering, for He laid down His life of Himself, since no man had power to take it from the Almighty Son of the Most High."

"Was there any particular meaning in the veil of the Temple being rent in twain from the top to the bottom, as soon as our Lord died on the cross?" inquired Agnes, who had been listening with serious attention.

"We cannot doubt it," answered her mother. "The Temple was the far larger, more substantial building which took the place [1] of the Tabernacle of the wandering children of Israel; it, too, had its veil of rich work to shut out from mortal view the Holy of holies. But as soon as the One great Sacrifice had been offered on the cross, when the dying Lord could cry out 'IT IS FINISHED,' then followed the rending asunder of the hiding veil, as a sign and type that all the Lord's people, through His precious blood, might freely enter heaven, the real Holy of holies, and appear

without dread of meeting His wrath in the presence of God the Father."

[1] The Temple standing at the time of our Lord's death was not Solomon's, which had been burnt more than six hundred years before.

CHAPTER VII

DRAWN ASIDE

THE subject of the preceding conversation had been so exceedingly solemn that even little Elsie had a grave look of awe on her round rosy face, though she could understand but little of the great mysteries of which her mother had been speaking. Elsie could only gather that a type was like a picture of something much greater and more wondrous than itself, and said in her simple, childish way, "Is not a type like your very tiny photo, mamma, so little that we could not make out that there was any picture at all till we held it up to the light, and then we could see the Queen's great palace quite plain?"

"Elsie has given us a type of a type!" cried Lucius clapping his little sister on the shoulder.

"What do you mean by that?" asked Agnes.

Lucius was puzzled to explain his own meaning, which was perhaps not very clear to himself, so his mother came to his help.

"Elsie's very minute photograph is not a bad illustration of what Bible types are," she remarked. "They look small, and might almost escape notice, until the eye of faith sees them in the clear light of God's Word, and then what seemed little more than a speck, may be found to be a likeness of something grander far than a royal palace."

"It would be interesting to find out some other Bible types," observed Agnes.

"I was just going to propose that while I attend afternoon service you should all occupy the time of my absence in each finding a type, which we can talk over in the evening," said Mrs. Temple.

"I should like that!" cried Lucius. "I am glad of anything to make the afternoon less dull; for I know that as it is damp to-day we shall all have to keep within bounds," he added, Agnes having just begun a fit of coughing.

"I should like to find a Bible type if I could, but I'm afraid that I am too stupid," said Amy.

"You and me, we'll try together," cried Elsie, laying her plump dimpled hand on that of her sister.

"Ah! You think that union is strength, Pussie!" cried Lucius. "And that you two youngest of the party will together be a match for any one of the rest."

Little Elsie's brain had now been quite long enough on the stretch, and after jumping upon her mother's knee to give her "a good tight kiss," the child ran off to play with her Noah's Ark. The family then dispersed to various parts of the house, soon to reassemble at the cheerful sound of the dinner-bell.

After Mrs. Temple had started for church, Lucius, Agnes, and Amy took up their Bibles to search in them for types, while little Elsie amused herself with a book of Scripture pictures. Dora went to the room called the study,

in which the children usually learned their lessons in the morning and amused themselves in the evening, and in which they kept their workboxes and desks, and most of their books. Dora found no one in the study, and seated herself near the side table, covered with green cloth, on which stood her neat little workbox.

"Of course I am not going to do one stitch of my embroidery to-day, because this is Sunday," said Dora to herself. "But there can be no harm in just looking at my pretty pattern, and seeing whether it is likely to do for the inner curtains and veil."

Dora opened the box, and took out the pattern which lay on the neatly folded piece of linen which her mother had given to her just before the twins had gone upstairs to bed. She admired her own pattern, which was really drawn out with some skill, but she saw that it was not quite perfect. Her pencil lay close at hand, and Dora could not, or did not, resist the temptation to put in a few touches to this and that part of the drawing.

"I wonder how I should arrange the colours," she thought; "I wish that I had more scarlet in my reel, and I think that my blue skein is too dark; Agnes has some skyblue sewing silk, I know. Perhaps that would be better, or both shades might have a pretty effect, mixed with the scarlet and purple."

Dora took out her reels and skeins, and placed them beside her pattern, and tried to imagine the effect of the different combinations of colour. Would it be well for the cherubim to be worked in purple or blue, or entirely in thread of gold, like their wings? Dora was inclined to think

the last plan best, only gold thread is so stiff, and difficult to manage.

"WHAT IS ALL THIS, MY CHILDREN?" ASKED MRS TEMPLE.
[Page 8.

"WHAT IS ALL THIS, MY CHILDREN?"

ASKED MRS. TEMPLE.

"I shall never go to rest till I have made up my mind about this," muttered Dora to herself, "and how can I decide what will suit best till I try? And why should I not try?" Dora, with her coloured silks before her, was, like Eve, looking at the forbidden fruit, and listening to the voice of the Tempter, who would persuade her that evil was good. "There are some things which even mamma says are quite lawful to be done on Sundays, such as charitable works. Mamma herself dressed the cook's scalded arm upon a Sunday, and put in a stitch or two to keep the bandages firm. That was surely sewing on a Sunday, but then that was a work of charity. Well, but mine is a work of charity, too."

Thus Dora went on, while the dangerous current of inclination was gradually drifting her on towards breaking, in act, the Fourth Commandment, which she had all day long been breaking in thought.

"Our Tabernacle is to be the model of a holy—a very holy thing, just the kind of thing which it is right to think about on Sunday. Then it is to be made for a very charitable purpose. I am sure that bandaging the cook's arm is no better work than helping a ragged school; I don't think that it is really as good, for aunt's poor little pupils are taught to love God and read the Bible. No, it surely cannot be wrong to assist such an excellent work on any day in the seven."

Dora unrolled a length of blue silk, took out a needle and threaded it. She had almost succeeded in silencing conscience, at least for a time; she had almost persuaded herself that in amusing herself she was helping a holy cause; and that God would not be displeased at her breaking His commandment, because she was going to

work for the poor. There is, perhaps, no more dangerous error than to think that the end justifies the means—that it is lawful to a Christian to do evil that good may come.

Oh, dear young reader! If you ever find yourself trying to quiet conscience by the thought that to do a great good you may do a little harm, start back as if you caught sight of the trail of a snake in your path! Yes, for the serpent who deceived Eve is trying to deceive you also.

If Dora had been honest and candid with herself, she would have seen, as her fingers busily plied the needle, that she was really working for her own pleasure, that her embroidering a piece of linen was an utterly different thing from her mother's bandaging a badly-scalded arm, and relieving a sufferer's pain. To cases of necessity such as that, the Saviour's words truly applied—"It is lawful to do good on the Sabbath day;" but there was nothing to justify Dora in following her own inclination, and working on the day appointed for holy worship and rest.

If there was really no harm in what she was doing, why was it that Dora started so when she heard her mother's voice at the door of the study, and why did she so hurriedly thrust linen, pattern, and silks back into the workbox as Mrs. Temple entered the room?

Dora's back was turned towards the door, so that, from her being between it and the table, Mrs. Temple could not see the cause of the little bustling movement which she noticed on coming into the study.

"What are you doing, my love?" she asked.

"Nothing," answered Dora quickly, as she succeeded in shutting down the lid of her workbox. The word was uttered in haste, without reflection; but the instant after it had passed her lips, a pang shot through the young girl's heart, for she was aware that, perhaps for the first time in her life, she had uttered a downright falsehood.

Conscience could be silenced no longer; the second sin into which Dora had been drawn by her fear showed her in a strong light the nature of the first, into which she had been drawn by her love of amusement. If she had not been doing what was wrong, she would not have been afraid lest her occupation should be found out by her tender, indulgent mother.

Mrs. Temple never doubted the word of one of her children, but she could not help thinking that the manner of Dora was strange, and she would probably have inquired further into its cause, had she not just then been followed into the study by Lucius. The boy had his Bible in his hand, and a thoughtful, perplexed look on his face, which Mrs. Temple noticed at once. Dora was glad that her mother's attention should be drawn by anything from herself, for otherwise she could not have hidden her confusion. She seated herself on a stool by the window, with her face turned away from her mother, and there remained a silent listener to the following conversation between Mrs. Temple and her son. Whether that conversation was likely to make Dora's conscience easier or not, I leave the reader to judge.

CHAPTER VIII

SACRIFICES

"I HAVE been looking out for a type, mamma, as you wished us to do," said Lucius, seating himself on the sofa on which Mrs. Temple had taken her place, and resting his Bible upon her knee. "I am not sure whether I may not have heard already from you that Abraham's sacrificing his dear son is a kind of shadow of God's sacrificing His only his Son. At any rate, I thought of this as the type which I should choose to speak of in the evening."

"You could have hardly chosen a more remarkable type, my boy. I believe that Abraham was commanded to sacrifice his son not only to try the fond father's faith and obedience, but also that Isaac ascending Mount Moriah with the wood for the burnt-offering on his shoulder, might be to the end of time a type of the blessed Saviour bearing the Cross on which He was to suffer on Calvary."

"Ah! Mother, it is all that suffering and sacrificing that is such a difficulty to me!" exclaimed Lucius. "Why is so much suffering needed at all?" The boy looked earnestly into his mother's face as he spoke.

"It is a sad mystery, Lucius, we do not fully understand it; but one thing is certain, not only from what we read in the Bible, but from what we see in the world around us, and that thing is that sin and suffering are bound together, we

cannot separate them. Suffering is the shadow of sin and 'must' follow it; THE WAGES OF SIN IS DEATH."

"But you have taught us that GOD IS LOVE," said Lucius thoughtfully.

"Surely God is love," replied Mrs. Temple; "God loves man, but God hates sin, which is the greatest enemy of man. It is God's merciful will that man should be saved 'both' from sin here, and from its most terrible punishment hereafter."

"The Holy of holies is a difficulty to me," observed Lucius; "why should no man, save the high priest, be suffered to go in, or draw near the mercy-seat of God?"

"Ask yourself what lesson this would have taught you had you been one of the children of Israel," said Mrs. Temple. "When you behold the Tabernacle with the wondrous cloud resting upon it, and gazed through the opening in front on the veil which hid from your eyes the more dazzling glory within—that glory which was a sign of the immediate presence of God, into which, on pain of death, you dared not enter—what would have been the thought uppermost in your mind?"

"The thought that God was terribly holy, and that no human being was fit to come near Him," replied Lucius gravely.

"But one man was allowed to draw near," observed Mrs. Temple.

"Only the high priest, and that with the blood of a sacrifice," said Lucius.

"And so mankind were taught that there is a way to approach a holy God, but 'only one way;' they were taught that sacrifice was needful, that WITHOUT SHEDDING OF BLOOD THERE IS NO REMISSION" (forgiveness of sin) (Heb. ix. 22).

"But, mother, surely God does not require the blood of bulls and goats!" cried Lucius.

Mrs. Temple in reply turned over the leaves of the Bible, till she found the fortieth Psalm, and then read aloud,—

> "'Burnt-offering and sacrifice hast Thou not required. Then said I, Lo! I come: in the volume of the book it is written of Me, I delight to do Thy will, O my God.'

"It is the Lord Jesus Christ who says this by the mouth of David. The blood of lambs and other creatures was worthless, save as signs and pledges of the precious blood of Christ which cleanseth from all sin, the blood of Him who is indeed THE LAMB OF GOD THAT TAKETH AWAY THE SIN OF THE WORLD."

THE SCAPE-GOAT

THE SCAPE-GOAT.

"It seems so sad that the Lord, who had done no sin should have to bear all that agony on the cross," murmured Lucius.

"Christ bore it in our STEAD," said Mrs. Temple; "He suffered the punishment for sin, that sinners, repenting and believing, might be saved, forgiven, and made happy for ever."

"I still cannot clearly make out the use of sacrifices—I mean of animals," said Lucius.

"They taught that one being may suffer instead of another," replied Mrs. Temple, speaking slowly, that her son might weigh well every word. "When an Israelite brought a lamb for sacrifice, it was just as if he had said,—

"'O holy God, I know that I am a sinner, and that I deserve to suffer for my sin; but in mercy accept the life of this lamb "instead of mine."'

"It was to teach this same lesson that Aaron the high priest was commanded to lay his hands on the head of a living goat, and confess over him the sins of all the children of Israel. The scape-goat (as it was called) was then sent away into the desert bearing away with him all the sins which had been solemnly confessed over him by the high priest of God. With a thankful heart and lightened conscience must every faithful Israelite have seen the scape-goat led away from the camp.

"'My sins are taken from me, far as the east is from the west,' he might say, 'I shall never never have to bear that terrible burden myself.'"

"But why have we no scape-goats and no sacrifices now?" asked Lucius.

While Dora silently thought, "What a comfort it would be to see all one's sins carried far away from us for ever!"

"We need no more such sacrifices now," replied Mrs. Temple, "because the One great sacrifice which Christ made of Himself on the cross is so infinitely precious, that it is enough to save a world that was lost from sin. We need no scape-goat now, for when Christ went forth to die, He carried away with Him the burden of the guilt of all His people."

"But then, mother, is every one's sin taken away? Is every one sure to enter heaven, the real Holy of holies?" asked Lucius.

The question was a very important one, and poor Dora's heart beat fast as she listened to hear what answer her mother would give.

"No, my dear," replied Mrs. Temple, "for not every one has true faith in the Lord and His Sacrifice, that faith which makes us repent of sin, be sorry for sins, confess it and try to forsake it. We know that (two only excepted) all the Israelites above a certain age never reached the good land of Canaan, but all died in the desert. And why was this? It was because they had sinned against God. They might have sacrifices but they had not true faith; they might give up lambs, but they gave not up sin; they might have God's presence in this tabernacle to guide them, but they did not let their conduct be guided by the light of His holy Word."

"It almost seems to me," observed Lucius, "as if the Israelites wandering about in the desert were types of us—of all who are now called Christian people."

Mrs. Temple smiled with pleasure to see that her son was beginning really to understand a little of Old Testament teaching by types. "Yes, dear boy," she replied, "the history of the Israelites is just like a picture or type of what is now happening to ourselves in our journey through life towards heaven. But you have heard enough for the present. Remember most of all the foundation truths on which we must surely build:

"First, that we all are sinners.

"Secondly, that we can only be forgiven and enter heaven through the Sacrifice of our Lord on the cross.

"Thirdly, that His Sacrifice takes away all sin from those who have true faith in their hearts; that faith whose reality is shown by its making us repent of and try by God's help to give up our sins."

CHAPTER IX

CONCEALMENT

DORA felt very unhappy. She had broken the holy rest of the Lord's day; she had repeated prayers without praying, heard God's Word read without attending, had made a vain show of religion; and at last had worked and worked hard at her needle, as she might have done on any other day of the week. Dora had disobeyed what she knew to be the wishes of her mother, and then to hide such disobedience had uttered a lie to deceive her! The girl could not conceal from herself that she had done what was wrong —exceedingly wrong; that she had displeased a holy God, whose eyes are in every place beholding the evil and the good.

"Oh, what can I—what ought I to do now?" thought she, as slowly and sadly she went up to her own little room.

Conscience gave an instant reply, "Retrace your steps as quickly as you can, own your fault to your mother, and ask forgiveness from God."

But Dora was very unwilling to do this, she was inclined to take a kind of half-way course.

"I need not say anything to mamma about what I have done," she thought. "I will not touch my pretty work any more on Sunday; and to-morrow, as soon as I get up, I will unpick every stitch of what I have been sewing to-day. That will be a good punishment for me; yes, that will be the right kind of punishment for breaking the Fourth Commandment."

Dora half satisfied her conscience by making this resolution to undo what ought not to have been done; but the little girl made a grievous mistake in supposing that any self-inflicted punishment can take away sin. We must go straight to the Lord for forgiveness, and ask it only for the sake of the Lamb of God, who suffered to take away guilt; and when we have sinned against any fellow-creatures, as well as against our Heavenly Father, we must honestly and openly confess to them what we have done, and ask their forgiveness. Dora shrank from doing this; she was extremely unwilling to own to her mother that she had been sewing on Sunday.

"Perhaps mamma would take away from me the making of the embroidered curtains altogether," she thought, "and give it to Agnes instead; and then all the family would know the reason, and I should be lowered in the opinion even of little Elsie! Oh, how dreadfully ashamed I should feel, and what a bitter disappointment it would be to see the work in the hands of another, after I have taken such pains to draw out that beautiful pattern! Worst of all, Aunt Theodora would hear of my fault when we go to be with her at Christmas. She would be sure to ask why her goddaughter had not embroidered the veil and the curtains, for she thinks that I embroider so well. Oh, I could not bear that the aunt whom I love so much—who loves me so much—should know what I have done! No, no, there is no use in speaking about the matter at all; I will punish myself by the tiresome unpicking, and then all will be right."

Would all be right? Were Dora to punish herself ever so severely, would all be right?

"Could my zeal no respite know,
Could my tears for ever flow,

All for sin could not atone,
Thou must save, and Thou alone."

Dora was only deceiving herself now, as she had an hour before deceived her indulgent mother.

In the evening, after tea-time, the family assembled again in the study. Their usual employment on Sunday evenings had been to sing hymns with their mother, each in succession choosing a favourite hymn; but the whoopingcough had for weeks past put a stop to all singing, and it had cost Mrs. Temple some thought to find a way of making the Sabbath evening hour as pleasant to her family as it had usually been.

The searching in the Bible for types had been a new kind of occupation, and had made the afternoon seem less long to the young prisoners at home than it might otherwise have appeared during the absence of their mother at church.

The family circle looked a very happy one by the light of the fire round which they gathered. For autumn was beginning, the weather, though not very cold, was damp, and the illness from which the children were recovering made warmth and dryness so desirable that the fire was always lighted at sunset.

"I like when we sit so cosy together before the blazing fire!" exclaimed little blue-eyed Elsie, cuddling close to her mother. "I hope that Eliza won't bring in the candles; no one wants candles to talk by. Agnes, you won't cough so

badly if you put your feet here on the fender. Please, Lucius, give the fire a good stir, and make the red flames leap up and dance. Are we not a happy party!" she added, squeezing tightly her mother's hand in both her own.

Smiling faces gave the reply. There was but one face that wore no smile. Dora sat on the other side of her mother, but the girl had drawn her chair a little back from the half-circle before the fire, and held a hand-screen before her face, not really to protect it from the scorching blaze, but that it might not be seen by the firelight. Dora was glad, but not for the same reason as Elsie, that Eliza did not bring in the candles.

CHAPTER X

DEAD FAITH AND LIVING FAITH

"HAS my Amy thought of any Scripture type?" said her mother, turning towards her.

Amy hesitated a little; she was always distrustful of herself, and in this was a great contrast to Elsie.

Mrs. Temple smiled encouragingly upon her little girl. "I see that there is something in your head," she said; "tell us, my dear, what you have thought of. If you have made a mistake, I will try to set you right; we are at least likely to gain some increase of Scriptural knowledge by talking over such subjects as these."

"I thought at first that I should never find out anything," said Amy; "though you explained to us so much about types yesterday, dear mamma, I felt quite puzzled when I tried to make out one for myself. At last, a verse from the third chapter of John came into my mind, and I wondered whether our Lord Himself taught Nicodemus about a type? Perhaps Nicodemus understood the Lord's meaning, but I could not understand it—that is to say, not clearly—so I thought that I had better ask you about it, mamma."

"What is the verse?" asked several voices at once.

Amy spoke reverentially as she repeated the sacred words. Mrs. Temple would never allow her children to gabble over carelessly any verse of Scripture.—"'As Moses lifted up the Serpent in the wilderness, so must the Son of Man be lifted up, that whosoever believeth in Him should not perish, but have eternal life.'"

"You told us all about it last Sunday, mamma," Elsie eagerly said; "I remember the story quite well. The people had been wicked, very wicked, and so fiery serpents came amongst them and bit them; and many—I don't know how many—Israelites died, because no doctor knew how to cure them."

"Were those deadly bites a type of sin whose wages are death?" asked Lucius.

"Indeed they were, my dear," said his mother. "Man had no way of saving those who had received the deadly wound, so God Himself showed Moses a way. The Lord bade him lift up on high a serpent of brass, and promised that whoso 'looked' upon it should live."

"I cannot imagine how mere 'looking' could do the least good to a person dying of the poison of a snake-bite," observed Agnes.

"God Almighty willed that it should be so," said Mrs. Temple; "He willed that the look of faith should bring healing to a sick body, as the look of faith at a crucified Saviour still brings healing to the sin-wounded soul."

"What do you mean by the look of faith?" inquired Agnes.

"Faith is simply 'believing,'" replied Mrs. Temple. "To look to Christ is to believe that He is able and willing to save us, and that none can save us but He."

Dora, who had chosen, as we know, to sit a little drawn back from the circle, and with a screen in her hand, now dropped the screen on her lap, and leant forward so that the red flickering gleam of the firelight shone on her face

as she anxiously asked, "Then are we quite, quite safe, sure never to be punished for any thing evil that we have done, if only we have faith that the Lord will save us?"

"Yes, if the faith be 'real' living faith," replied Mrs. Temple.

"Are there then two kinds of faith?" inquired Lucius.

"Yes," answered his mother; "we read in the Bible of two kinds of faith or belief—one dead and one living."

"I cannot understand that at all," said Amy.

"I will try to explain," said her mother; "and I ask you, my children, to give me your full attention, for this is a matter of the greatest importance. You all believe, do you not, that there is an Emperor of Germany?"

"Yes, yes," replied the children; and Elsie added with a little nod, "I believe there is such a man, though I never have seen him."

"Now does your belief in the existence of the Emperor—that is, your 'faith' in it—does it make the smallest difference in your actions, or words, or feelings?" inquired Mrs. Temple.

"No; why should it?" cried Lucius.

"The Emperor does not care for us; he knows nothing about us," said Elsie.

"Then your faith in the Emperor is a 'dead' faith, it has no effect on your hearts," observed Mrs. Temple. "And this is the kind of faith which many persons, alas! have in the

Lord. They believe, in a careless sort of way, that Christ once lived in the world, and died on the cross, but they believe only with the head, not with the heart. And this is 'dead' faith, a kind of faith which never can save us."

"But what is a 'living' faith, then?" asked Amy.

"When our belief makes us really love Him who first loved us; when the thought of Christ's dying for sin makes us hate sin that cost Him so dear, then our faith must be living faith; and thus looking to the Lord we are saved."

Dora sighed and drew her head back again into the shadow. Hers was not a faith that had kept her from sin—hers was not a faith that made her now obey the whisper of conscience, confess her fault to her mother, and make what amends she could for what she had done.

"Depend upon it, that when an Israelite had been cured of his wound by looking at the brazen serpent, he did not go and stroke and play with the fiery reptiles that had bitten him," observed Lucius, who had the clearest head amongst the party, and best entered into the meaning of types.

"No, he would run away from the horrid creatures, or try to kill them; he would put his foot upon the fiery serpents and crush them—crush them!" cried Elsie, stamping her little foot on the hearthrug to add force to her words.

"So every one who has living faith dreads and hates sin, and tries to destroy it," observed Mrs. Temple. "We shall not carelessly trifle with it 'if we believe from our hearts' that our blessed Redeemer suffered because of our sins."

CHAPTER XI

LEPROSY

"AS we seem to be giving in our types youngest by youngest, it is Dora's turn now to tell us which she has chosen," said Lucius.

"Ah! Dora will have found out the most interesting type of all; Dora is so clever!" cried Elsie, who had great faith in the intelligence of the brighter of the twins.

All eyes were turned towards Dora as she sat in the shadow, but Dora's own eyes were bent on the hearthrug. She had been so much taken up on that Sunday, first with her embroidery, then with the conversation between her mother and Lucius, and the painful struggle in her own mind with an upbraiding conscience, that she had not even thought of looking out for a type in Scripture.

"What have you chosen, Dora?" asked Lucius.

"I have not chosen any type yet; I have not had time," stammered out Dora, confused and mortified to find herself behind even little Elsie, who looked astonished at the words of her sister.

"Not time! Why, you have had as much time as any of us," said Agnes. "What were you doing all the afternoon while mamma was at church?"

"Nothing particular," said Dora, with a little confusion. Again a pang shot through the heart of the conscious girl, for she knew that she was again staining her lips with untruth.

"You don't mean to say that you were sitting from two o'clock till five with your hands before you, and thinking about nothing at all?" said Lucius.

"Perhaps Dora was reading that interesting book about the poor French Protestants," suggested Amy.

Dora did not speak. She was too well pleased, alas! that her family should believe that she had been thus engaged, though she knew that she had not so much as opened the volume in question.

"It would have been better, my love, for you to have entered into the occupation which interests your brother and sisters," said Mrs. Temple, in a tone of gentle reproof. "Even reading a nice Sunday book like the one Amy mentioned may become a selfish amusement if it keeps us from adding a little to the general pleasure."

"I never knew Dora take such a reading fit before," muttered Lucius; "she generally likes to use her fingers more than her head."

The remark was a very commonplace one, yet it added to Dora's confusion.

Mrs. Temple, noticing her daughter's look of annoyance, though she attributed it to a different cause from the true one, turned the conversation by asking Agnes whether she had thought of a Scriptural type.

"Yes, mamma," replied Agnes. "I believe that leprosy is a type of sin, and the cure of lepers a type of the cure of sin, just as the looking up at the brazen serpent was a cure for the deadly bites."

"You are perfectly right, my dear," said her mother.

"What is leprosy?" asked little Elsie.

"A dreadful kind of illness," replied Agnes.

And as she seemed disinclined to say more, perhaps from fear of bringing on her cough by speaking, her mother continued the description of this terrible type of sin.

"This frightful malady is still well-known in the East," said Mrs. Temple. "Your uncle, who came lately from India, has told me that he has seen many poor lepers there. The leprosy makes them loathsome to the eye; it creeps over their bodies; it wastes their flesh; when it fastens on their hands, it will make the very fingers drop off!"

"Oh, how dreadful!" exclaimed all the children.

"Dreadful indeed, but not 'so' dreadful as the sin which it represents," said their mother sadly; "for the soul's sickness is more dangerous, its effects infinitely more lasting."

"I don't quite see how leprosy is a type of sin," observed Amy.

"I think that we are led to believe it to be such by the very particular commands regarding it in the law of Moses," said Mrs. Temple.

"Did poor people with leprosy never get well again?" asked Elsie, with pity expressed on her round little face.

"Yes, they did sometimes recover," said her mother, "but not by such means as are used in cases of other sickness. Not a doctor, but a priest, was to judge whether the leper were cured, or, as it was called, 'clean;' and he had to bring a special offering to be sacrificed to the Lord."

"I suppose the offering was that sheep which we see in the picture?" said Elsie, for the illustrated Bible had again been brought and placed upon Mrs. Temple's knee, and the firelight was sufficiently bright to show a picture representing a cured leper coming to the high priest, to find which Mrs. Temple had turned over the pages.

THE LEPER'S OFFERING.

THE LEPER'S OFFERING.

"That picture shows but a part of the offering," replied Mrs. Temple. "When the candles come in, I will read to you from the 'Pictorial History of Palestine,' written by the famous Dr. Kitto, a description of a very peculiar ceremony which took place before the sheep and two rams were slain as a sin-offering."

"Ah! Here come the candles—just when we want them!" cried Elsie, as Eliza brought them.

"I'll get Dr. Kitto's big book!" exclaimed Lucius, jumping up from his seat by the fire.

The candles were placed on the table, near enough to Mrs. Temple to enable her to read without quitting her warm seat, but merely turning her chair round to the table. She then read aloud the following extract from the work of the learned doctor:—

"'When a person was reported to be free of his leprosy, a priest went out of the camp and subjected him to a very strict examination. If no signs of the disorder appeared upon him, the priest sent a person to bring two living birds (doves or young pigeons), cedar wood, scarlet wool, and hyssop, with which he performed the ceremonies of purification, to admit the party to the privileges of the Hebrew Church.'"

"What does that mean, mother?" asked Lucius.

"That the man was no longer to be cut off, as were lepers in Israel, from worshipping the Lord within the camp, or mixing with the rest of the people," replied Mrs. Temple.

"Oh, mamma, might not a poor leper do that?" exclaimed Amy. "To be shut out from praying with one's friends and relations would be almost the worst trial of all!"

"Remember, my dear, that the dreadful disease was infectious; there was need of the greatest care lest it should spread in their camp. Lepers had to wear a particular dress, and to live apart from all who were yet in health. If any one drew near to a leper unawares, the afflicted one had to cry out, 'Unclean! Unclean!'"

"I don't think that I will ever again complain of being shut up from friends and playmates because of this whooping-cough," cried Lucius. "It is disagreeable enough to be kept as we are even from going to church; but fancy what it would be to have to cry out, 'Unclean! Unclean!' if any one chanced to come near us!"

"Please, mamma, go on with the account of what the priest had to do with the two birds which he sent for when he found that the leper was quite well again," said Amy.

Mrs. Temple continued her reading:—

"'He slew one of the birds, and received its blood in an earthen vessel. Into this he dipped the cedar wood, the scarlet wool, and the hyssop, and therewith sprinkled seven times the once leprous person. The other bird was then permitted to escape, as a symbol that the man was now free of his leprosy.'"

"Oh, how joyful the bird must have been when allowed to fly free up!" exclaimed Elsie.

"Not more glad than the poor cleansed leper, of whom that bird was a type," observed Mrs. Temple. "Think of his joy at being free to return to his family—his wife and his children; and his thankful delight when worshipping once more with his former companions in the court of the Tabernacle of his God!"

"It seems to me that there is a verse in one of the Psalms which shows that David had the cleansing of a leper in his mind when he prayed to the Lord to forgive him his sin," remarked Lucius.

"I was just thinking of the same when mamma read about the hyssop," said Amy; "it made me feel sure that Agnes was right when she chose leprosy as a type of sin. 'Purge me with hyssop, and I shall be clean; wash me, and I shall be whiter than snow.'"

"Oh, mamma! I remember the story of the poor leper who came to the Lord Jesus," said Elsie, "and how he cried, 'Lord, if Thou wilt, Thou canst make me clean!'"

"Yes, indeed, Elsie, and how deeply interesting is the Saviour's reply, 'I will, be thou clean,' if we look upon leprosy as a type of sin," observed Mrs. Temple. "The Lord was able and willing to heal, not the poor man's body alone, but also his soul; and make him free from all stain of sin as well as from all taint of disease."

CHAPTER XII

NAAMAN

"THE leper story which has always interested me most is that of Naaman the Syrian," said Lucius, when he had put back Dr. Kitto's large volume in its place in the book-case.

"Oh yes, yes," interrupted little Elsie; "I know that story too quite well. I know that Naaman was a great man, and rich, and a famous general besides, but he had the dreadful sickness which no doctor could cure. I remember how Naaman came in a grand chariot with prancing horses to the house of the good prophet Elisha, and how angry he was when only a servant came out and told him to wash seven times in the river Jordan."

Elsie stopped almost out of breath from the rapidity with which she had spoken. All the young Temples were familiar with the account of the cure of the Syrian, which was one of their favourite Scripture stories.

"Was the leprosy of Naaman also a type of sin?" inquired Lucius.

"I believe that it was," answered Mrs. Temple, "and I am strengthened in this belief by Naaman's leprosy coming upon Gehazi as a direct punishment for his sin."

"Ah! That wicked Gehazi!" exclaimed Elsie. "He told a lie, a dreadful lie! It was right that he should be punished, was it not?"

The question was asked of Dora, Elsie's favourite sister. The child wondered at the unwonted silence which had come over Dora, and wanted to draw her into conversing like the rest of the party.

Dora winced at the question, and only replied by a slight movement of her head.

But little Elsie was not satisfied by this. "Why don't you speak?" she said bluntly. "When people are so very naughty as to tell lies, and say that they are doing nothing when they are doing something bad, don't you think that they ought to be well punished for it?"

Forced to reply, for Elsie's question had drawn every one's attention towards her, Dora answered, "Of course they should be punished." And having thus pronounced sentence upon herself, she relapsed into silence, feeling much inclined, however, to start up and escape from the room.

"Are you not well, my love?" asked her mother, who could not help noticing that Dora's manner was different from usual.

"Quite well, mamma; only a little tired," was the evasive reply.

"Tired of doing nothing," said Lucius.

The conversation on the subject of Naaman was then resumed by Agnes.

"When Naaman was cleansed of his leprosy, mamma, how was it that Elisha did not tell him to go and show himself to the priest, and that we hear nothing about a sinoffering, nor of a bird being set free?" asked the elder twin.

"You must remember," replied Mrs. Temple, "that Naaman was not an Israelite but a Syrian, a Gentile, and, that he was therefore not bound to observe the ceremonial law of the Jews. I think that Naaman was a type of a Gentile church, to which belong all Christians who are not descended from Abraham and Isaac."

"To which we then belong," observed Lucius.

"Notice, my children," continued their mother, "how we see the history of a converted soul in the story of Naaman's cure. First there is the man possessing all that earth can give him, but afflicted with a deadly disease."

"Like the people who were bitten by the fiery serpents," interrupted Lucius.

"Here in the leprous Naaman we behold a type or picture of a soul with unforgiven sin staining and corrupting it," said his mother. "Next we find the leper at the door of the prophet. Can any one of you tell me of what Naaman now is a type?"

"A seeking soul," replied Agnes, after a little pause for reflection.

"Ah! But the next picture is of the leper turning away quite angry because he was told just to wash and be clean," cried Elsie.

"Then Naaman is a type of a proud soul, not content with God's simple but wonderful plan of salvation," continued their mother. "There are some persons now who think that they can earn heaven by doing some great thing, who believe that because of their own goodness they can be clean in the sight of God. Such persons, like Naaman, are offended and hurt when they are told that all their good works cannot take away sin; that the leper can only be saved by living faith in Him whose blood is the fountain opened for all uncleanness."

"But Naaman did go and dip down seven times in Jordan as he was bidden," cried Elsie; "and then he was made quite well, his flesh all soft and clean, just like a little child's."

"This is a picture or type of a believing, forgiven soul," said Mrs. Temple, "the picture of one who has become a child of God, and who is resolved, by the help of His Spirit, to lead from henceforth a new life."

CHAPTER XIII

THE TWINS

"THESE types are really beginning to be quite plain to me now, mother," said Lucius, "and they make the Old Testament seem to me to be very much more beautiful than it ever seemed before. I remember how puzzled I have been by some words in one of the Epistles about the rock which Moses smote in the desert, and from which the waters gushed out. St. Paul wrote 'that Rock was Christ,' and I never could make out what he meant, for how could the rock be the Lord? But now I understand, at least I think that I do, that the Apostle meant 'that smitten rock was a TYPE of Christ,' and so everything becomes plain.

"But can one object be a type of more than one thing, mamma? For there is something which we have just spoken of as being a type of what heals our souls—I mean by that, true living faith in the Lord; and I have thought of something quite different, of which it seems also a type."

"Are you speaking of the river Jordan?" asked Agnes, through whose mind the same thought had been passing.

"Yes, the river in which Naaman dipped seven times and was cleansed," replied Lucius. "When the Israelites, after their long wanderings in the desert, came to that same river Jordan, there was nothing but its waters

between them and the Promised Land, which mother told me to-day is a type of heaven."

"And the waters were divided to let the people pass over quite easily and safely," interrupted little Elsie, who never missed an opportunity of bringing out any knowledge which she had gleaned.

"Hush, Elsie! You distract my thoughts," said her brother, "and make me forget with your prattle what I was going to say. Oh, it is this! When Christians have almost got over their long life-journey, there is only one thing at last that divides them from heaven, their Promised Land; and that thing is death. Mother, is not Jordan a type of death?"

"I believe that it is," said his mother.

And Amy silently thought of those beautiful verses which allude to this type:—

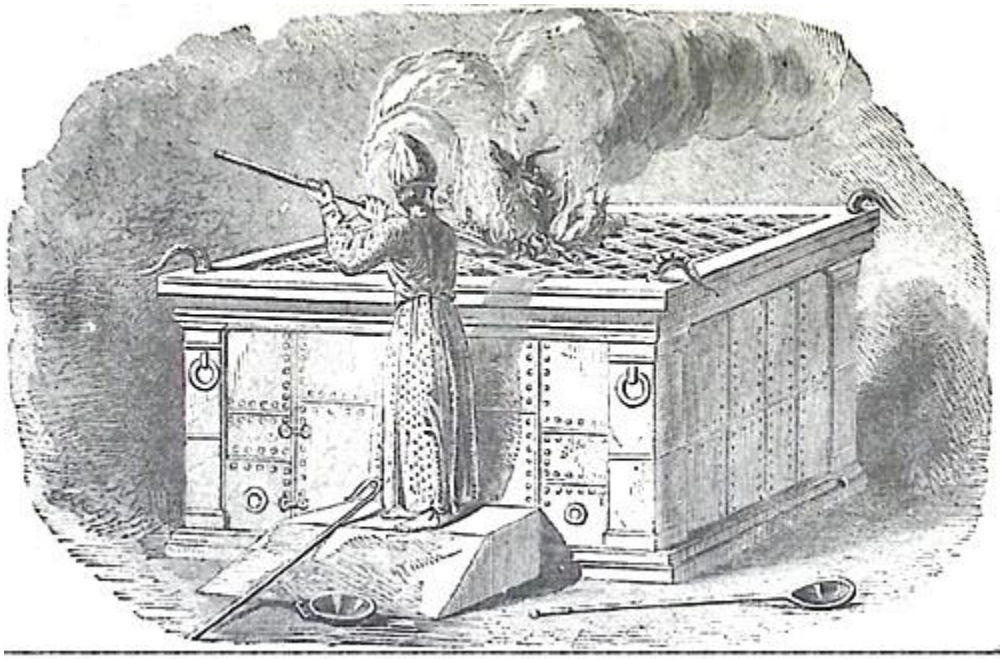
"Oh! could we bid our doubts remove,
  Those gloomy doubts that rise,
 And view the Canaan that we love
  With Faith's unclouded eyes;

"Could we but stand where Moses stood,
  And view the landscape o'er,
'Nor Jordan's stream, nor death's cold flood,'
  Could fright us from the shore."

"I also believe," continued Mrs. Temple, "that the dividing of the waters, which enabled the Israelites to pass over without so much as wetting their feet, is type of the

terrors of death being taken away from the Christian. Safe through the atoning sacrifice, and happy in the love of his Lord, the believer can peacefully pass on to his promised land—heaven—with as little cause for fear as the Israelites had in crossing the dry bed of the Jordan."

"Ah! The Israelites were a happy people," said Amy softly. "Think of their having God always to guide them by the pillar of fire and cloud, and holy Moses always to pray for them; and the beautiful promised land Canaan before them, and so many wonderful miracles worked for their good! I almost wish," she added, "that I had lived in those days."



THE ALTAR OF BURNT-OFFERING.

THE ALTAR OF BURNT-OFFERING.

"Happier are Christians in these days, my child," said her mother, "for they know more, far more, of the Saviour's love than was ever made known to the people of Israel. We have God's sure Word to guide us in our wanderings through the desert of life, and we have beyond that desert a far brighter laud than Canaan, even heaven, promised and purchased by Him who prepares good things for those who love Him; and we have One far greater than Moses—One who ever liveth to plead for us at the right hand of God while we fight our battles against sin.

"Moses was a being of flesh and blood as we are; his arms grew tired, he needed to have them held up by Aaron and Hur; but the Lord Jesus in praying for His people never grows weary, and His love never grows cold. My children, when life was most like a desert to me, when your father had crossed the Jordan and left me behind, I cannot tell you what comfort and support I found in the knowledge of Christ's prayer and the thought of Christ's love!"

Mrs. Temple's voice faltered, and Amy felt the hand which she was clasping tremble. Their mother now very seldom gave way to any outward burst of sorrow in the presence of her children; her manner was usually cheerful and bright. But the elder ones could well remember how great had been her grief in the first sad days of her widowhood, when their father's useful life had been closed by a peaceful death. The young Temples all respected their mother's sorrow, and when she paused from emotion, the room was so still that the crackling of the fire and the tick of the clock were the only sounds to be heard.

But Mrs. Temple was not willing to throw even a brief shadow over the cheerfulness of her little family circle, and would not now have given way to her feelings had not

bodily weariness and pain made her less able to control them. She very quickly recovered her usual tone, and said, in her wonted cheerful manner, "My little Elsie's eyes are growing sleepy, she can hardly manage to keep them open! My birdie had better fly up to her snug warm nest, and prepare by a good long rest for a busy to-morrow."

"Oh yes, to-morrow will indeed be a busy day!" exclaimed Lucius. "I mean to be up with the lark. I hope, mother," he added, "that you won't mind the noise of my hammer?"

Mrs. Temple with a smile assured her boy that she would not mind anything. She had not been a mother so long without becoming accustomed to noise, and she would be just as much interested in the progress of the work of her children as they themselves could be.

"You will like me to get on with my little red curtains?" said Elsie, in rather a drowsy tone.

A fond kiss was the mother's reply; and then Mrs. Temple herself took her youngest child up to her bedroom, for she always liked to hear Elsie repeat her evening prayer.

About an hour afterwards all the other young Temples had wished their mother good-night, and retired to the rooms in which they slept. The twins shared the same room. It was a very pretty one, adorned with framed pictures painted by their Aunt Theodora, and lighted by candles in elegant green glass candlesticks, which had been a birthday present to them from their mother. Both the

girls were, on the night in question, more silent than usual, but from different causes.

As Agnes sat slowly brushing out her long plaits of brown hair, stopped every now and then by her cough, her thoughts dwelt much on the subject of the Israelites and their journey through the wilderness, which she was now taught to regard, not only as a historical fact, but also as a type of the life-journey of Christians.

Agnes was not by natural disposition so merry and lighthearted as were her brother and sisters, and this difference between her and the rest of the family was all the more marked at the time of which I am writing, from the health of the elder twin being a good deal shaken by her illness. She had naturally a peevish, passionate temper, which greatly marred her own peace of mind, and which prevented her from winning much love from her young companions. She had many faults, and she knew that she had them: they were to her a trouble and burden. The young girl honestly wished to get rid of and conquer these faults, but she wanted energy and spirit to make a really good battle against her besetting sins. She was too much disposed to conclude that because she was ill-tempered, she must always continue ill-tempered, that there was no use in striving to subdue her evil nature.

The elder twin was wont to feel vexed and to look sullen because Lucius never cared to sit and chat with her as he would with Dora; and because Elsie never threw her arms round her neck as she would round Amy's. It grieved her to notice that no one ever called her "pet," or seemed to take delight in having her near.

"I know that it is partly my own fault," she would often say to herself, in bitterness of soul; "but I don't think that if I were to leave home for months, there is any one but mamma who would miss me or want me back."

Such thoughts had only the effect of making the poor girl's temper more cross, and her manner more peevish; it is so hard for the face to look bright and sweet when gloom is within the heart.

But better thoughts were in her mind on that Sunday night, as she sat silently brushing her hair. Sweet and comforting was the reflection that she was not left to fight her battle alone, that there was One who would not only hear her prayer, but who would Himself pray for His feeble child—who would both watch her struggle against sin, and give her strength in that struggle. It was sweet to poor Agnes, when she afterwards knelt down to pray by the side of her bed, to feel that if she was, like an Israelite, bitten by the serpent of sin, she knew where to look for a cure; that if she was like Naaman the leper, there was the Fountain open to her, in which she could wash and be clean.

Hope had sprung up in her heart, and with hope came increase of courage. Agnes remembered that the Lord who had supplied all the need of the Israelites could supply hers also; and when temptations assailed her, as the enemy assailed that people, could make her also mere than conqueror through the power of His Holy Spirit.

Very, very different were the thoughts passing through the mind of Dora, though outwardly she was doing exactly the same things as were done by her twin sister. Dora was "not" making a brave battle against inward sin, but was,

like a coward and traitor, going over to the enemy's side. It is true that she still intended to unpick on the Monday morning all that she had sown on the Sunday afternoon; but this resolve was made on the false principle of punishing herself for the sin which she would not honestly confess, and of which she had never truly repented. This idea of self-inflicted punishment was merely her contrivance for quieting conscience, that conscience which had been very uneasy during the conversation on the subject of leprosy, the terrible type of sin. But Dora was trying, and with tolerable success, to banish from her mind all thought of that conversation. It was far more pleasant to think of the pattern of the Tabernacle curtains than of the holy things of which that Tabernacle should remind us.

A great many persons—even grown-up persons—act, alas! like Dora. They so fix their attention on outward things in religion that they quite overlook the inward meaning. Such self-deceivers are ready enough to work at what pleases the eye and amuses the fancy, and believe that they are making an offering to God; but the cleansing of the heart, the giving up sin—these are duties which they shrink from, and which they willingly put off to "a more convenient season."

CHAPTER XIV

WORK

ALMOST every inmate of Cedar Lodge was up very early on the Monday morning, Agnes being the only member of the family who did not rise till her usual hour. The first crow of the cock, strutting about in the yard behind the house, roused little Elsie from sleep. The child was restless and impatient in her white-curtained cot, until she was suffered to rise, dress, and set about her Turkey-red work for the model. Amy was bending over her strip of white linen almost before there was sufficient light for her to see how to thread her fine needle, for the morning was dark and rainy; indeed the sun never showed his face during the whole of that day.

Drip, drip! fell the rain, but none of the children regretted that they were not likely to go out of the house.

"I don't mind the rain one bit!" cried Elsie. "I'm glad that it rains; we'll get on so famously with our work!"

Drip, drip! fell the rain; clink, clink! fell the hammer of Lucius; and blithe sounded his whistle, as he laboured in the midst of his squares of pasteboard, strips of wood, and lengths of wire. The schoolboy set to his work with a will; and how pleasant is work when we have strength and spirit to do it, and feel that we have a worthy object before us!

No one was up earlier than Dora. She sprang from her bed before twilight had given place to daylight, so impatient

was she to get to her embroidery pattern again. The noise of Dora's rising awoke Agnes, who had not passed so good a night as her more vigorous twin had done, the sickly girl having been several times disturbed by her cough.

"What are you about, Dora?" murmured Agnes, in a drowsy and rather complaining tone. "I'm sure that it can't be nearly time to get up."

"Oh! I like to set about my new work quickly, and get a good piece of it done before breakfast," was Dora's reply.

"There will be plenty of time for work between this and Christmas; I wish that you would keep quiet and let me rest," yawned Agnes.

"You can rest if you wish it; I won't make a noise," replied Dora. "But for my part I like to be up and doing. You know that—

"'Early to bed, and early to rise,
  Is the way to be healthy, wealthy, and wise.'"

Agnes said nothing in contradiction of the old proverb which her sister quoted, but turned round on her pillow, and with a weary yawn composed herself again to sleep. She thought that it would be time enough to get up when Susan should call her at a quarter to seven, and she only wished that Dora had thought so also, for it fidgeted her to hear her moving about in the room.

But Dora had cared as little about disturbing the sleep of a sickly sister as she had about letting her mother go out in the rain. She admired her own energy, and looked upon

Agnes almost with scorn as being lazy, cold, and dull, with not a bit of enthusiasm in her nature.

"We should not have had a model worth looking at had the embroidery been left to her," said Dora to herself, not without a feeling of self-complacence, as she glanced at her twin, who had again sunk into slumber.

It will be remembered that Dora had resolved to unpick all the work that she had sewn upon the preceding Sunday. As soon as the little girl had hastily finished her toilet, so hastily that she forgot to button her sleeves or put on her collar, she opened her workbox, took out her work, and seated herself as close to the window as possible, in order to catch as much as she could of the dim light of dawn.

DORA RESOLVED TO UNPICK ALL HER WORK. [*page* 106.

DORA RESOLVED TO UNPICK ALL HER WORK.

It might have been expected that Dora would also have forgotten to say her prayers, but such was not the case.

She remembered to kneel down by her bedside and hurry through a mere form of words, without paying the slightest attention to their meaning, thinking of her embroidery all the time. It was a satisfaction to the conscience of Dora that she had repeated a prayer, and she never stopped to ask herself whether that prayer were not in itself a sin.

Dora with needle and scissors set first to her work of unpicking. But every one who has tried such an occupation must know it to be one of the most tedious and disagreeable of tasks. It was doubly so to Dora, because she greatly admired the embroidery work which she was thus beginning to spoil.

"It is a great pity to undo this," Dora said to herself before she had been for two minutes plying the scissors. "I won't go on with this foolish unpicking. After all, my undoing every stitch of my pretty work would not undo the fault of my having put it in on Sunday."

This was indeed true. A fault once committed, no human being has power to undo; but while looking to the Lord alone for forgiveness, we are bound to prove the sincerity of our regret for a fault by making what amends lie in our power. Dora took the easier, but far more dangerous way, of trying to forget the fault altogether, or to make up for it by what she considered to be her zeal in charity work. She certainly sewed very diligently on that dull morning, scarcely lifting her eyes from the pattern which she had neatly traced on the linen. She was filling up the pencilled outlines with chain stitch, satin-stitch, and other stitches, in bright-coloured silks and thread of gold.

"Oh, look!—Just look how famously Dora has been getting on with her work!" exclaimed the admiring Elsie,

when, summoned by the bell at half-past eight, the children had assembled in the breakfast-room, awaiting their mother's coming down to prayers.

"Why, you don't mean to say that you have worked all that this morning?" said Lucius to Dora.

The question was rather an awkward one for Dora to answer—it took the girl by surprise. Dora replied to it by an evasion, which was another act of deceit. "I couldn't begin my embroidery on Saturday night," she said, actually congratulating herself that she had this time spoken "the exact truth," as if it were not the very essence of falsehood to "deceive," even though the lips may utter no lie. As Dora had not sewn on Saturday, she knew that Lucius would take it for granted that she had been so clever and industrious as to do all the work which he saw on the Monday morning, for he would certainly never suspect her of having put in one stitch upon Sunday.

"Don't you admire Dora's curtain? Is it not lovely?" said Amy to Agnes, who was examining the work of her twin.

"Rather," was the reply, uttered in a hesitating tone.

Agnes could not truthfully have expressed warmer admiration, for she did not think that the figures of the cherubim were at all gracefully drawn, nor did she consider that the colours were perfectly blended, there being too little scarlet in proportion to the purple and blue. But the cold praise of the twin was not unnaturally set down by her family as coming from a mean, unworthy motive.

"She is as jealous as a cat!" exclaimed Lucius. "Agnes can't forgive poor Dora for having been trusted with the most difficult part of the work."

The irritable temper of Agnes fired up in a moment at an observation which she felt to be unjust as well as unkind. But Agnes on that Monday morning had not merely said her prayers, she had really prayed for grace to conquer besetting sin; and now, though she could not help her cheeks flushing scarlet at the taunt of her brother, she pressed her lips closely together, and kept down the passionate reply which it was so hard, so very hard, not to utter.

"How much of your work have you done this morning, Agnes?" asked Elsie, rather proudly, showing her own three inches of seam in the Turkey-red cloth.

"I have cut out my mohair curtains," said Agnes, who had also, though she did not choose to say so, been mending her gloves, in obedience to the known wish of her mother.

"Cut out—only cut out!" laughed Lucius, who had been doing great things in the nailing and hammering line. "If you take the matter so easily, Agnes, every one will 'cut you out,' though you may not be made into curtains!"

Agnes was provoked at the joke, and all the more so because Dora and Elsie laughed, and Amy could not help smiling. Few persons like to be laughed at, and the peevishtempered Agnes was certainly not one of the few. But the girl had made a resolve, not in vain trust in her own power of carrying it out, but in a spirit of humble prayer, to set a watch before her lips; and if she could not speak

kindly, not to utter a single word. Agnes could not, indeed, yet manage to take a disagreeable joke with good humour, but she bore it in resolute silence, she did not utter any retort.

CHAPTER XV

DIFFERENT MOTIVES

NO one admired Agnes Temple, no one praised her self-command: she was thought lazy because she had not eagerly rushed into an occupation in which she took no particular pleasure, and for which she knew that she would find plenty of time without neglecting more homely duties; she was thought jealous because she had simply spoken the truth. And yet on that day, Agnes had begun a nobler work than that of embroidering in purple and gold, and her offering was a far more acceptable one than that of which Dora was proud.

"What a busy, cheerful little party!" exclaimed Mrs. Temple, as she entered the study on the afternoon of that same day, and found all her children sitting together, sewing, cutting, gilding, and chatting merrily as they worked. "You remind me of the busy, happy scene outside Jerusalem, beheld every year when the Feast of
Tabernacles was kept."

"What was the Feast of Tabernacles, mamma?" inquired Amy.

Lucius would have asked the same question, but he dared not speak at that moment lest his breath should blow away the sheet of gold leaf with which he was trying to cover his wires.

"The Feast of Tabernacles was a yearly festival held by the Israelites in remembrance of the time spent by their fathers in tabernacles or tents in the desert," replied their mother. "This was the most cheerful of all the feasts, and was kept in a remarkable manner. The people made booths for themselves of the branches of palm, willow, and other trees, and for seven days lived in these booths. There were processions, glad hosannas, and sounds of singing and mirth. The people enjoyed their out-of-door life, and blessed the Lord for His goodness in guiding the Israelites through the wilderness to the good land in which their children now dwelt."

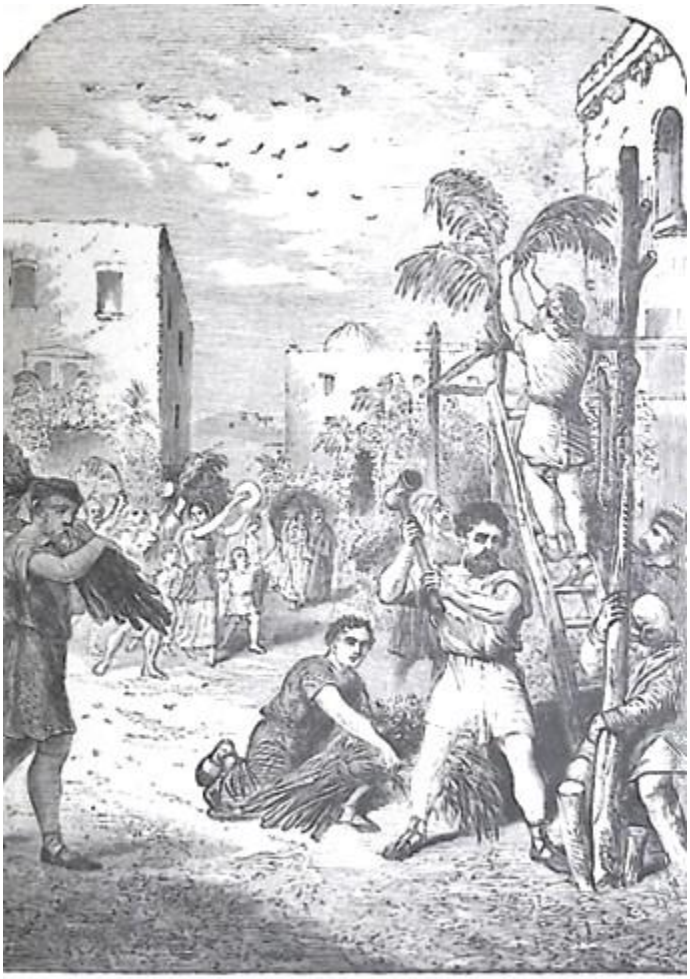
"One could hardly keep such a feast in England," observed Agnes, glancing out of the window at the grey sky and the dripping trees, which were dimly reflected in the pools left by the morning's rain.

"I think that living in green leafy booths would be delightful in summer, even in England!" exclaimed Lucius, who had managed to fix his gold leaf. "I should have liked, had I been a Jew, to have kept the Feast of Tabernacles—better perhaps than to have helped to make this model Tabernacle," added the boy, who, after several hours of steady work, was beginning to feel rather tired. "I should much prefer hewing down branches, and doing the rough carpentering part of the business, to gilding these tiresome, fidgety wires, which I am sure to ungild again as soon as I attempt to fix them into their frame."

"What, you are weary of your work already!" exclaimed Dora, as she paused in her sewing to thread her needle.

"Not exactly weary of it now," answered Lucius, "but I guess that I shall be so long before this model is finished. It is all very well," he continued, taking up his knife to hack away at some stubborn pasteboard—"it is all very well to make pillars and curtains while the sky is cloudy, and the rain falls fast, and I am kept prisoner at home; but suppose that the rain should stop, and the sun shine out, and the weather become settled at last, wouldn't every one of us like running about in the fields all day, playing at cricket, or croquet, or rounders, better than measuring and cutting and—There! Snap goes my knife, my new knife!" And with a gesture of impatience the boy flung the unmanageable pasteboard down on the table.

There was much to justify the suspicion expressed by Lucius that the work so eagerly begun by the Temples would, before it could be finished, become a burden and tax upon the patience of all.



THE FEAST OF TABERNACLES.

THE FEAST OF TABERNACLES.

On the very next day began a season of warmth and sunshine, which did more to drive away coughs and restore vigour to late invalids than could all the skill of the doctor. Even Agnes was able to spend hours in the open air; and, except at meal-times, Lucius liked to be out all the day. His fidgety work, as he called it, could scarcely be done but indoors, and the boy found it a grievous task.

"But it would be a shame not to go on with the model now, after putting mamma to so much trouble and expense," observed Lucius one morning to Dora. "Besides, I engaged to do it, and no English boy must flinch back from keeping his word. The new knife which I bought yesterday is not to be compared to that which I so unluckily snapped over the pasteboard; but I must hack away steadily, and show a good example to that lazy puss Elsie, who since the fine weather began has not put another stitch into her Turkey-red curtains."

"She has stowed them away in her doll's cradle," observed Dora, laughing.

Mrs. Temple was not surprised to find that the making of the model now progressed more slowly; she was rather pleased to see the amount of perseverance shown by her children after the charm of novelty had worn off. Even the "lazy puss" drew her work from its hiding-place, and would sew—for five minutes at a time—"just to please dear mamma."

All the five Temples continued to work, when work had ceased to be an amusement; but they worked from different motives. Those which influenced Lucius—a manly, honourable boy—have been mentioned already, as well as the simple wish to please her mother which made Elsie prick her plump little finger under her Turkey-red cloth. But if we could glance into the hearts of the three other girls as they sit together industriously plying their needles, we should find an example of how the very same effect may be produced by different causes.

Amy had from the very first considered her humble work as something to be done for her Heavenly Master, and this sweet thought made her take pleasure in labour, which without it would have been wearisome indeed. It was this thought which made Amy put fine hemming and stitching into the long strips of white lawn which represented the linen curtains surrounding the court of the Tabernacle, and even unpick any portion which did not seem to her to be sewn neatly enough. Amy tried to give her best, her very best work, because she was giving it to the Lord, and some of the happiest hours which the little girl ever had known were spent over her tedious curtains.

"I cannot think, Amy, how you can go on so patiently with what is so tiresome, with no variety in it, and a kind of work which will not look striking when all is done," exclaimed Dora one day, as she unrolled some glittering gold thread from her reel.

Amy smiled as she glanced up at her sister's far more amusing occupation. "If I could have worked anything so pretty as the veil which you are making, I daresay that I should have liked it much better," she observed. "But I am pleased to do the plain work as well as I can, as the embroidery would have been far too difficult for me."

Amy's curtains might seem plain to the eyes of most people, but her mother looked upon them with special pleasure; for, as she said to herself, "they are embroidered all over with faith and love."

Agnes also made steady progress with her not very inviting work, though she took in it no great pleasure. Agnes regarded the sewing as a matter of duty, and

therefore plied her needle in the same spirit as that in which she struggled to subdue her temper, and tried to put a bridle on her tongue. It was the work which had been given to her, and she would do it, without asking herself whether she liked it or not.

"This material, neither smooth nor pretty, is something like a type of me," thought Agnes, as she put the finishing stitch into one of her mohair curtains; "but the goat's hair had just as much its appointed place in the Tabernacle as loops of silver and sockets of gold. I shall never be as much liked and admired as Dora is—I may as well make up my mind to that—but if God help me by His grace, I too may lead a useful life, and be dear—at least to my mother."

And more and more dear was Agnes becoming to her mother, who watched with the keen eye of affection the struggle made by her eldest daughter against her besetting sins. Mrs. Temple guessed what it cost Agnes to bear a rough joke in silence, to lend pretty things which she feared that the borrower might spoil, to give up her own way, and to show no jealous anger when another was preferred before her.

"My girl's character is becoming stronger and nobler every day," thought Mrs. Temple; "I thank the Lord for my Agnes, for I am sure that it is His grace that is working in her heart. Agnes promises to grow up into a really valuable woman, one whom her mother can trust."

Mrs. Temple could not have said as much for her dearly loved Dora. She was perplexed and pained to feel that something—she knew not what it could be—seemed to have come between her and her bright, clever, and affectionate

child. Dora, indeed, gave Mrs. Temple no cause to find fault with her conduct; her lessons were well learned, her temper was good, she was a favourite still with her brother and sisters; and yet her mother felt that there was a change in her Dora for which she could not account.

Mrs. Temple was wont to have little quiet conversations separately with each of her children at night; in these meetings they were able to open their hearts more freely to their mother than they could have done had a third person been present, and she could speak upon religious subjects in the way best suited to the character and age of each. These quiet moments spent alone with mamma had been greatly prized by all the children; but Dora could take pleasure in them no more, and her mother was conscious that such was the case.

The girl generally managed, only too easily, to forget all about her unrepented sin when the remembrance of it was not forced upon her now half-deadened conscience; but when her mother sat by her bedside and softly talked to her about heaven, Dora grew uneasy in spirit. She did not like to be reminded of the holy God whose law she had broken— what pleasure could the knowledge of His truth bring to one who was conscious of unrepented falsehood? The return of Sundays, nay, even the hour for family prayer, were never welcome to Dora. When she repeated texts or hymns, as the rest of the family did, she had the wretched consciousness that she was acting a hypocrite's part, and taking God's name in vain. Dora's life was becoming one long act of deceit. She was secretly ashamed of herself for appearing so much better than she in reality was.

"But my work—my beautiful work—my work for the poor —I'll make up for what I've done wrong by taking extra pains with that!" thought Dora.

And so the poor girl usually succeeded in winning much praise from others, and in deceiving her own sinful heart, only too willing to be thus deceived.

CHAPTER XVI

THE HIGH PRIEST

"THERE is one thing which we can't do, it is too hard for even Dora," observed Elsie one morning at breakfast, when, as was often the case, the Children's Tabernacle had formed a topic of conversation. "We can't make models of the Ark, or the Altar or the Table of Shewbread; our pretty curtains won't cover anything, the Tabernacle will be quite empty!"

"I really could not undertake to do more than I am doing, even if my fingers could manage to make such tiny models," said Lucius, who, as we have seen, already found that he had engaged in a difficult task.

Agnes, Dora, and Amy were silent; they all felt that there would certainly be a great want in their Tabernacle, but they did not see how that want could possibly be supplied.

The young Temples little guessed that while their mother was in her own room, engaged, as they supposed, in reading or writing, or making up her household accounts, she was preparing for them a pleasant surprise. Mrs. Temple was not less with her family than usual; she did not neglect her house affairs, she never forgot either to order the dinner or to pay the butcher and baker, but she stole time for her novel employment from her sleep, and from her favourite amusement of reading library books.

On the day when the model was completed, when the last silver socket had been fastened and the last little curtain hemmed, the children had the pleasure of setting up the Tabernacle in the study, to see how it looked. There was great satisfaction in surveying the finished work; every one felt glad that the long labour was over, and that he had had a share in the work.

"How pleased auntie will be!" cried Elsie.

"And the ragged children, too," joined in Amy.

"And now go out for your walk, my dear ones," said their mother; "the morning is so frosty and bright that you may make your walk a long one; I should not be surprised should you wander as far as Burnley woods. I shall not expect you back for a couple of hours."

"Mother, you will go with us," said Lucius.

"I am particularly engaged this morning," replied Mrs. Temple, as she shook her head with a smile.

Elsie remarked afterwards that it had been "a knowing kind of smile," as if there had been some very particular reason indeed for her mamma's stopping at home.

The reason was clear enough to all the party when they returned from their walk, and with their cheeks rosy from the fresh air and exercise re-entered the study. The children found their mother standing beside the model. Elsie, who was the first to run up to it, gave almost a scream of delight.

"Oh! See—see what mamma has been making! Clever mamma!" she cried, clapping her hands, and jumping for joy.

"What lovely little models!" exclaimed Lucius. "Mother, it is you who have cut us all out."

"You have done what none of us could have done," said Agnes.

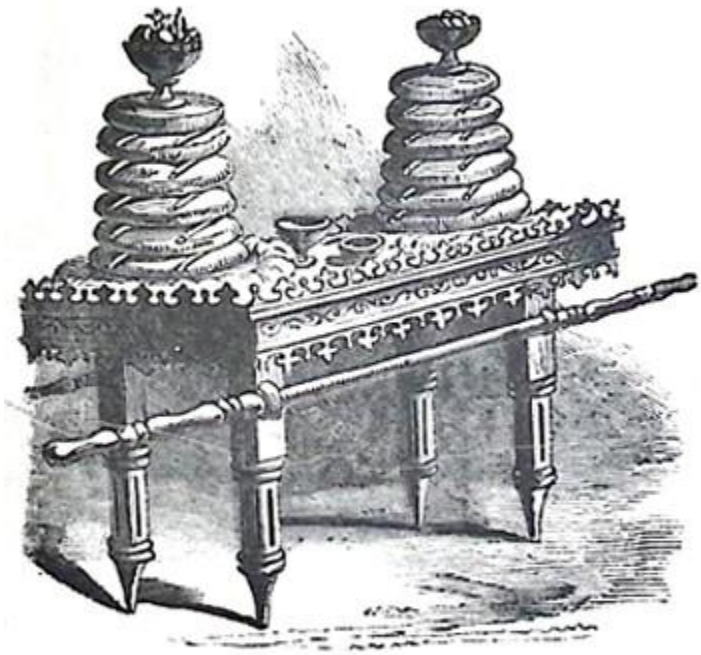
"And so quietly too," observed Dora.

"There is nothing wanting now!" cried Amy, putting her arm fondly around the mother who had so kindly entered into the little pleasures of her children.

"I thought that one thing more was wanting," said Mrs. Temple.

The lady seated herself beside the table, and took off the cover of a little pasteboard box which she held in her hand. The children looked on with mingled curiosity and pleasure, as their mother carefully drew out from it a beautiful little figure, about two inches long, exquisitely dressed in miniature garments, representing those which were worn by the high priest of Israel. To imitate these garments in a size so small had taxed the utmost skill of the ingenious and neat-fingered lady.

I need not set down all the exclamations of wonder and pleasure which were uttered by the younger Temples. If their mother's great object had been to gratify her children, that object was certainly attained.



THE TABLE OF SHEWBREAD.

THE TABLE OF SHEWBREAD.

"The dress which I have tried to imitate," said the lady, "is that in which the high priest appeared on solemn occasions. The Day of Atonement was, however, an exception; on that most solemn day in the year, when the high priest ventured into the Holy of holies, he did so in simple garments of pure white linen."

Their mother then showed and explained to her children the different articles of dress on her curious model. The under-tunic, or shirt, of linen, and above it the mantle of

sky-blue colour, having at the bottom an ornamental border or fringe.

"This fringe, which, as you see, I have cut out in the form of tiny pomegranates, ought to be interspersed with bells of gold," said Mrs. Temple; "but my fingers could not succeed in making anything so very minute."

"And unless we had looked through a microscope, we could not have distinguished bells no bigger than needles' eyes," observed Lucius.

"And what is this fine uppermost garment, reaching to the knees?" inquired Dora, looking admiringly on the delicate embroidery in gold and colours similar to that which she had herself worked for the Veil, only a great deal finer.

"This is the Ephod," replied Mrs. Temple. "On the front of it I have, as you see, worked in very small beads of various colours an imitation of the high priest's breastplate, which was formed of twelve precious stones."

The minute breastplate excited more attention than any other part of the high priest's dress, and had, perhaps, given the skilful worker more trouble than all the rest. Every one of the little beads was of a different tint. They were closely set together in rows, so as to form a square ornament, and were fastened to the shoulder parts of the Ephod by little threads of gold.

"How very splendid the real breastplate must have been!" exclaimed Dora.

"Had it also some typical meaning?" asked Lucius. "I suppose so," he added, "as everything about the Tabernacle

and the high priest seems to have been a type of something greater."

"On each of the precious stones in the splendid breastplate was inscribed the names of one of the twelve tribes of Israel," replied Mrs. Temple. "I believe that the breastplate was worn by the high priest—who was to pray in the Tabernacle for the people, and then to come forward and bless them—as a token that he bore their names on his heart."

"Oh, that is a beautiful meaning!" cried Amy. "Especially when we think," she continued more softly, "that the high priest was a type of our blessed Saviour Himself."

"Who bears all His people's names on His heart," observed Mrs. Temple, "both when He pleads for them in heaven, and when He blesses them upon earth."

"The high priest must have looked very noble and grand in his rich garments," observed Lucius; "and yet it seems too much honour for any mere man to be called a type of the Son of God."

"Ah, my boy! Poor and mean indeed must any earthly type appear when compared to the heavenly Antitype!" exclaimed Mrs. Temple. "That thought came strongly to my mind as I was sewing together these little worthless glass beads to form the model of the glorious breastplate. 'Can these poor little atoms of coloured glass,' I said to myself, 'give any idea of magnificent jewels, sparkling in light, set in gold, and each engraved with a name?' But even so mean, and small, and insignificant was Aaron, in all his splendour, compared to the sacred Being who deigns to call

Himself our High Priest, and to make intercession for us above!"

THE HIGH PRIEST.

THE HIGH PRIEST.

All the party were silent for several moments, looking down at the little model, and thinking over the words of their mother.

Elsie then pointed to the curious headdress which appeared on the figure. It was not exactly a turban, though

it was formed of tight rolls of linen. It had the representation of a plate of gold in front, fastened on to it by a blue thread.

"That headdress is called the high priest's bonnet or mitre," observed Mrs. Temple. "There are rather different opinions regarding its exact shape. It cost me a good deal of thought to contrive it, and here again I felt how impossible it is to give anything like a just idea of the real object in a model so small as this. You see that I have not neglected to put a little gold plate on the front of the mitre; but I had no power to form letters so minute as to represent on it what was engraved on that which the high priest wore. This was 'HOLINESS TO THE LORD.'"

"Then the high priest had the Lord's Name written over his brow," observed Agnes. "It makes one think of the promise in the Bible, that saints in heaven shall have His Name written on their foreheads."

"All will be 'Holiness to the Lord' in that happy place!" observed Amy.

It was pleasanter to Dora to examine the little model before her, and to admire and praise her mother's skill, than to think of what was inscribed on the mitre worn by Aaron and his successors. It is the sad, sad effect of sin concealed in the heart, that it keeps those who indulge it from daring even to "wish" to be holy.

The Tabernacle was now carefully taken down, piece by piece, to be packed in a box, ready to be carried with the rest of their luggage when the family should quit their home for awhile. Every curtain was neatly folded, and all the pillars carefully wrapped up in paper. The figure

representing the high priest was gently put back into its own little box, and all the other little objects were packed in cotton, so as to bear without injury a little jolting on the journey before them. With additional pleasure the young Temples now looked forward to the coming Christmas season, and the long expected visit which they were to pay to their Aunt Theodora.

CHAPTER XVII

THE BIRTHDAY GIFTS

SEVERAL months have passed away since the Temples began making their model of the Tabernacle of Israel. The leaves which were then green on the trees have become yellow, have faded and fallen, save those on the evergreens, which wear a silver crusting of frost.

But it is not to Cedar Lodge that I shall take my young readers, but to a large and rather plain brick house in the city of Chester.

It is a house by no means beautiful to the eye, and its only look-out is into a narrow paved street; but still that house has a charm of its own, it is dear to many a heart, for its owner, Miss Theodora Clare, is the friend and benefactress of the poor around. Many have entered sadly through the dark green door of that redbrick house who have left it cheerfully, blessing the kind heart and liberal hand of its owner.

It is just two days before Christmas: on the morrow Miss Clare's Ragged School is to have its annual treat. A feast and gifts of warm socks or mittens knitted for each child by the lady's own hands are not to form the only, or perhaps the chief attractions of the treat; the little scholars have been promised a sight of the model Tabernacle, which its young makers are to bring from their country home about ten miles away.

Christmas Eve has been fixed upon by Miss Clare as the time for her Ragged School Fête, because it is the birthday of her twin nieces, the younger of whom is her goddaughter and namesake. The arrival of the Temple family is expected almost every minute, and Miss Clare sits by the window, with the red glow of a December sun upon her, glancing up with a look of pleasant expectation whenever she hears the rattle of wheels along the narrow paved street. You might guess at once by the likeness between them that Miss Clare is the sister of Mrs. Temple, though her figure is a little taller, and her locks a little whiter than those of her widowed sister.

Miss Clare is evidently thinking; she looks a little perplexed and doubtful as she examines the contents of a large old-fashioned ebony box which holds her little treasures. Not treasures of silver or gold; there are but few indeed of such things in the possession of Theodora Clare: her silver spoons have fed the hungry; her gold chain has paid for the benches on which her ragged scholars sit, and her bracelets for the books which they learn from, and the big blackboard on the wall. A good many pairs of stout little shoes have come out of Miss Clare's silver tea-pot! But there is one article of jewellery which she still possesses, and this is to her the most precious of all. It is the likeness of her sister, Mrs. Temple, in a brooch set round with pearls. This was the gift of Mr. Temple on his wedding-day to the bridesmaid, Theodora; it is very beautiful as an ornament, and as a likeness almost perfect. But not even this jewel does the generous aunt intend to keep for herself; it is to be her birthday present on the following day to Dora.

Miss Clare has for years settled in her own mind that her goddaughter should receive the precious brooch on completing the twelfth year of her age; it is no doubt this subject that perplexes her now—for she does look a little perplexed as she searches her old-fashioned box for something which she seems to have some difficulty in finding. She opens this little packet, then that little packet, then silently shakes her head, or murmurs "No, that will not do," as she replaces it in the large box. The reason is that Dora has a twin sister, and that the birthday of the one is also the birthday of the other. Miss Clare does not like to give to Dora without also giving to Agnes, and as her hospitality and her charities leave her very little money for buying presents, she wishes to find some suitable article already in her possession of which to make a birthday remembrance. But what should that article be? Almost everything that would please a young girl had already been given away.

"I have nothing—nothing that can be compared in value or in beauty with the brooch," said Miss Clare to herself, as she locked the box where she had been vainly searching amongst locks of hair neatly wrapped in separate papers, old letters, and little pictures faded and yellow with time. "I hope that Agnes is too sensible a girl to expect that my precious brooch should be given to herself instead of to my namesake, who is to me almost as a daughter: but still Agnes is the elder of the twins; she is, I fear, of rather a jealous temper; her character has not—or had not a year ago—the generosity and sweetness of that of my Dora. I should be grieved to hurt the feelings of either of the dear girls; what can I find that will really please Agnes?"

Miss Clare had really given the subject a good deal of consideration, though apparently to little purpose, when a thought occurred to her mind which brought a smile of satisfaction to her kind pleasant face. She rose from her seat by the window, and went to a table which had in it a drawer hidden by the neat brown cloth that hung over the sides. The lady lifted the cloth, drew open the drawer, and then took from it a flat parcel wrapped in a peculiar kind of yellowish paper, with that scent about it which usually pervades articles which have come from India.

"Here is the delicate little embroidered neck-scarf which was sent to me years ago, and which I have always thought much too fine for my wear," she said, as she opened the parcel. "This will of course be a gift not to be compared to the brooch; but still it is pretty, very pretty. I think that Agnes is sure to admire it."

It was indeed impossible not to admire the exquisite embroidery in gold and colours on the small India-muslin scarf. The natives of India excel in this kind of work, and the little scarf was a gem of beauty for richness of pattern and brightness of hue. Miss Clare's only doubt was whether such an article of dress were not too gay to be given to her young niece.

Miss Clare had little time to think over this matter, for hardly had she put back the pretty piece of embroidery into its paper wrapping, and then replaced it in the drawer, when the rattle of wheels was heard on the stones, and a large carriage, well filled within, and with plenty of luggage without, was driven up to the door.

Well Miss Clare knew the smiling eager faces which crowded the carriage window, and the merry young voices

which sounded through the clear cold winter air. She ran hurriedly to meet and welcome the party, and was at the open door, notwithstanding the cold of frosty December, before Mrs. Temple and her five children could manage to get out of the carriage in which they had been too closely packed for comfort, but in which they had been very noisy and merry. All trace of whooping-cough had long since departed, and the sounds which had been heard in the carriage had been only those of talking, laughing, and singing!

CHAPTER XVIII

THE ARRIVAL

"MIND, coachman, mind! You must hand down that box very carefully!" shouted out Lucius to the driver, who was now engaged in taking down the luggage.

The boy had been the first of the party to spring out of the carriage, but he was the last to enter the house, for all his thoughts seemed to be taken up by the long, flat deal box which had been put under the special care of the coachman, with many a charge to see that no harm should come to it on the journey. Had the box been a cradle containing a baby it could hardly have been more gently and carefully received from the coachman's hands, and then carried up the door-steps and into the red-brick house by Lucius. Did it not hold the result of the labour of many weeks!—Was there not in it the work completed by the family's united efforts, the beautiful model of the Tabernacle made by the children of Israel!

"Oh, auntie, here is our great work—our model! Where shall we set it up? Have you a table ready? It is all finished—every loop! Oh, you must see it! You must see it!" Such were the exclamations which burst from the children as Lucius appeared in the hall, laden with the long, flat deal box.

Miss Clare had not yet seen the model, though she had heard a great deal about it, and had given notice to many friends and neighbours of the little exhibition of it, to be

held in her house through the following week, for the benefit of her school. She was amused at the eager impatience shown by the youthful workers. Except Agnes, who took the matter more quietly, none of the Temples cared even to warm themselves by the blazing fire after their wintry journey until the Tabernacle model had been unpacked from its box.

"Please, auntie, please don't look at it till it's all set up!" exclaimed Elsie, in a tone of entreaty. "You can talk to mamma, you know, while we are unrolling the little curtains (I did the Turkey-red curtains)—and fastening them up on the gilded pillars by the wee, wee loops which are made of silver thread!"

Miss Clare was quite willing to indulge the humour of her young guests, so that she did not even remain in the room while the Tabernacle was being put up on the table set apart for the purpose. She took her sister, Mrs. Temple, upstairs, and helped her to take off her cloak and furs, and talked over many subjects with her, while the young people below were busily engaged with their model.

It was not until nearly two hours had elapsed, and after the party had all partaken of a dinner of roast beef and plum pudding, that Miss Clare re-entered her own sittingroom to have her first sight of the wonderful work.

For wonderful it was in the eyes of its youthful contrivers, who knew the trouble which it had cost them to finish and fix those numerous pillars and curtains with sockets and loops. The Temples regarded their model as a triumph of art and patience, much as the builder of one of

the Pyramids may have regarded his own gigantic work. Miss Clare was expected to look and feel a good deal more astonished than she could in sincerity do; but if she was not astonished, at least she was pleased, and plainly showed that she was.

"It's a pity, auntie, that you can't see more of my Turkey-red curtains; I wish they'd been the top-ones," cried Elsie, lifting up a corner of the merino covering to show her own work beneath.

"These linen curtains round the court of the Tabernacle are neatly, very neatly made," observed Miss Clare; "with so many silver loops, they must have required a great deal of patience in the worker."

Amy coloured with pleasure at the praise; she had not expected her own share of the work to attract much notice. She now silently drew her aunt's attention to the pretty little gilded pillars upon which her curtains were hung.

"But the beauty part—the real beauty part—is the 'broidery, the inner curtains, and the veil!" exclaimed Elsie. "Oh, auntie, you will be astonished at them. Just stoop down and look in—just look in! We've managed to leave the front open, and the veil is half-drawn aside, so that you can see the inner part quite well. No one could see the inner part of the real Tabernacle, you know; but then ours is only a model."

Their aunt stooped, as requested, and looked through the space between the front pillars, not only into the outer Tabernacle, but beyond the veil into what, in the model, represented the Holy of holies. Dora, who had for months

been looking forward to this moment, listened eagerly to hear what her darling aunt would say of her work.

Miss Clare, it will be remembered, had that day been examining a lovely specimen of some of the most finished embroidery to be found in any part of the world. Dora's work was clever, regarded as that of a girl not twelve years of age, who had had to contrive her own pattern; but it was, of course, very poor compared to that on the Indian scarf.

"Is it not splendid 'broidery?" persisted Elsie, who wished others to share her own unbounded admiration for the work of her favourite sister.

"It is nice," said Aunt Theodora quietly, "but wants a little more scarlet, I think."

And was this all that could be said of that which had cost Dora hours of thought, and many hours of patient labour—these few words of qualified praise! Dora was bitterly disappointed, far more disappointed than Agnes, whose curtains, whether mohair or merino, seemed to win no notice at all. But there was good reason why Dora should feel pain which Agnes was spared. It was not time and labour only which the younger twin had given to gain success; she had made a sacrifice of conscience, she had forfeited her own self-respect, she had lost the blessing of confidential intercourse with her mother, and all pleasure and comfort in prayer! Dora had given up all this, and for what? To hear the observation, by no means unkindly uttered, "It is nice, but wants a little more scarlet."

If Dora had ever believed that in working her embroidery she had really been labouring for anything

higher than earthly pleasure or human praise, the extreme vexation which she now experienced must surely have undeceived her. Why should she care so much for what was said of her performance if her real object was but to please her Heavenly Master? Agnes and Amy, who had worked from motives of duty and love, were safe from any such keen disappointment. They both looked with pleasure on the completed model, in forming which they had taken inferior parts; while Dora had to walk to the window to hide from the eyes of her family the mortification which she felt.

That day was a very happy one to all the members of the Temple family, Dora alone excepted. She felt a kind of dread of the evening conversation which she knew that she would have with her aunt. The eve of her last birthday Dora remembered as, perhaps, the happiest time of her life. Aunt Theodora had come to sit with her, and talk to her of her coming birthday—a new milestone, as she called it, on the pilgrim path towards heaven. Dora had on that evening opened her heart to her godmother aunt, and the two had loved each other more fondly than they had ever loved before, and their parting embrace had been so sweet that Dora had felt that she could never forget it.

Miss Clare was certain to come again this evening into her godchild's room—in this house Dora had a little room to herself—and must the niece act the hypocrite's part to an aunt so loving and true? Must the girl so trusted and loved make a show of openness while concealing a secret from her godmother, which, if confessed, must lower her in the eyes of that tender relative and friend!

Miss Clare did indeed come that night, as Dora had expected that she would come. The girl soon found herself sitting on a stool with her arms resting on her godmother's

knee, as they had rested twelve months before; and she heard the same dear voice speaking to her of holy things, as she had heard on that well-remembered night. The room was the same, the furniture, the pictures were all the same, but Dora felt in her own heart a miserable change. Half a dozen times was the poor girl on the point of laying her head on her aunt's knee, and sobbing forth a full confession to relieve her burdened heart. But to own repeated falsehood and long deceit to one herself so truthful, to lose the good opinion of one whose regard she so greatly valued, oh! Dora could not muster up courage sufficient for this!

"And now that you are making a new start in life's journey, my child," such were the godmother's concluding words as she rose to depart, "give yourself anew to the best of Masters, the most tender of Friends. Ask His blessing upon all that you do: without that blessing our best works are but like building on sand, or writing on water—all end in vanity and vexation of spirit. The great lesson taught us by the history of ancient Israel is this: When God's people followed where He led, and did what He commanded, then were their hearts filled with joy; but when the Israelites turned aside to paths of disobedience, sorrow followed close upon sin. The path of obedience is the path of safety and happiness also."

CHAPTER XIX

DISAPPOINTMENT

THE birthday of the twins had arrived; but the sun rises late on the twenty-fourth of December, and Dora was up, dressing by candlelight, long before his first beams shone on the sheet of pure white snow which had fallen during the night.

It might be supposed that Dora's thoughts would be on the words of advice which she had heard on the previous night; but though these words had made some impression at the time, it was by no means upon them that the girl's mind was running when she awoke in the morning. Dora was thinking of her embroidery work—that work of which she had been so proud, that work which had cost her so dear. Nothing that Miss Clare had said dwelt so much on the memory of her niece as the simple observation, "It wants a little more scarlet, I think."

For on the mantelpiece of the room now occupied by Dora there chanced to stand a glass bottle, corked and labelled; and by the light of her candle Dora had noticed that "SCARLET INK" was printed upon the label. The sight of that little bottle had aroused in the mind of the girl new hopes, and again turned her energies into the channel of work.

"My supply of scarlet silk ran short, and I was not able to get another skein at the shop," thought Dora. "Aunt is quite right, there is not enough of scarlet mixed with the purple and blue; it is that which spoils the effect of my curtains. I wonder that no one noticed that before! But I have a skein of white silk with me, and why should I not dye it myself with that beautiful scarlet ink? This is a capital idea! The school children do not come till the afternoon; I should have time to dye my silk before breakfast, and after

breakfast to work enough scarlet into my pattern to give a brilliant effect to all that part which is most easily seen. How pleased Aunt Theodora will be to find that I have taken her hint, and that I grudge no extra trouble to make my work complete! How very lucky it is that she put that ink into my room!"

Dora actually forgot both her prayers and her Scripture reading on that birthday morning in her impatience to get downstairs, and quietly remove her inner veil and curtain from the model, before any other member of the family should enter the room where it was kept. With rough hair, and dress only half-buttoned, Dora noiselessly opened her door, and then crept down the staircase, and into the sitting-room in which the Tabernacle stood, covered from the dust by large sheets of silver paper. There was no one in the room except the housemaid, who was employed in opening the shutters to let in the light of morning.

The model, as we know, was made to be taken to pieces at will; but as Dora's sot of curtains was the innermost of all, it cost her some time and trouble to remove them. She pursued her occupation while the housemaid went on with that of lighting the fire and dusting the room, and was at last able to disengage the whole of the embroidered portion of the drapery of the little Tabernacle. With this Dora returned to her own apartment, and she laid her work on the pretty little table which her aunt had placed for her convenience.

"I must be quick about the dyeing," she said to herself, "for I hear Lucius whistling upstairs in the passage, and little Elsie running about in the room just over my head. The family is now all astir, and in a quarter of an hour the prayer-bell will ring. If I don't dye my silk scarlet at once, I

shall be sadly delayed in my work, for I cannot, of course, use it for sewing until it is perfectly dry."

Dora took the bottle of ink down from its place on the mantelpiece, and in a great hurry set about removing the sealing-wax which covered the cork, for the bottle had not yet been opened. It was a tolerably easy matter to break off the edges of the red wax, but Dora did not find it easy at all to pull out the cork, which was low in the narrow neck of the bottle, and happened to be a very tight fit.

"Dear! Dear! How troublesome this is!" she exclaimed, hunting about for her stout pair of nail scissors to help her in forcing out the obstinate cork.

"Good-morning, Dora dear, many happy returns of the day to you!" cried the merry voice of Elsie, as she tapped at the door of her sister's room.

"Thank you, darling, don't come in now; I'll soon be downstairs—I'm not quite ready!" called out Dora, who had just succeeded in finding the scissors.

She heard the little feet patter down the stairs.

"Happy birthday to you, Dora! Mind you're not late, Miss Twelve-years-old!" This time it was the voice of Lucius at the door.

"No, no, I'll not be late; I'll be down in ten minutes!" cried Dora, digging her scissors vigorously into the cork.

The clatter of Lucius's boots showed that he followed little Elsie.

"Oh! This cork, this tiresome cork!" exclaimed Dora.

"There, it's out at last."

And setting the opened bottle on the table, she turned round in a great flurry to get from her box the skein of silk which was to be changed from white to scarlet.

"More haste, less speed." Dora was not the first who had proved the truth of that proverb. She whisked round so rapidly that her dress struck the top of the bottle, which she had carelessly set down in a place that was not very safe. The bottle was knocked over, but it fell upon something soft which lay upon the table, so that it was neither broken, nor did it make enough noise in falling to attract Dora's attention. It was not till she had found the skein (which she had some trouble in doing) that on turning back to the table she perceived the mischief caused by her hasty movement.

What a start and exclamation of distress poor Dora gave when she saw on the table her embroidery lying actually under the overturned bottle, and soaked through and through with the scarlet ink, which had flowed in abundance from it!

Dora stood for a moment as if rooted to the spot, scarcely able to believe her own eyes. She then darted forward, caught up the half-emptied bottle in one hand, and the stained, dripping linen in the other. The first glance at the embroidery showed the poor girl that the mischief done was utterly beyond repairing; in one minute, the fruit of all her long toil had been completely destroyed!

"Oh, it is all my own fault—all my own fault—it could not have prospered!" cried out Dora, in a loud tone of anguish, as she put down first the bottle, then the

embroidery, and then, hiding her face with her scarlet-stained fingers, she burst into a passion of weeping.

That cry, that weeping, reached the ears of her aunt, who had just approached her door, carrying with her the destined gifts for the twins—the Indian scarf, and the brooch with the miniature set in pearls.

"My darling girl, what is the matter?" exclaimed Miss Clare, opening the door in alarm.

There was no need to repeat the unanswered question; the bottle, the little heap of embroidered linen dripping with scarlet ink, told their own story plainly enough. Miss Clare saw the nature of the accident which had happened, and, with kind sympathy for her niece's great disappointment, folded her affectionately in her arms.

CHAPTER XX

CONFESSION

"IT is vexatious, my Dora, very vexatious," said Miss Clare, in a tone of condolence; "it is trying to you, after all the pains which you have bestowed on your work, to see that work suddenly spoiled. But still take comfort, dear child, in the thought that no labour undertaken for our Master can really be lost."

Dora sobbed more bitterly than before, for she knew that hers had not been labour undertaken for the Master, and she felt that her time and toil had been worse than lost.

Miss Clare did all that she could to comfort her favourite niece. She showed Dora the beautiful brooch which she herself valued so greatly; she told her goddaughter that she had brought it as a birthday remembrance.

But, much to her surprise, Dora only shook her head sadly, and sobbed forth, "Not for me—not for me! Oh, that model, I wish that I never had touched it—I wish that I had never set a stitch in one of those curtains!"

"I see that you are distressed, very naturally distressed, by the mishap which has befallen your curtains, fearing that thereby the whole model may be spoilt," observed her aunt. "You are thinking of the disappointment of your brother and sisters, of the Ragged School children who are coming today, of my friends who are invited to see the model. You think that there is no time to repair the effects of the

spilling the scarlet ink; but I think that I see a way to remedy the mischief."

And Miss Clare, as she spoke, placed before the weeping girl her beautiful embroidered scarf. "I had intended to give this to Agnes when I gave you the miniature brooch, but I will now alter my plan. I will try to find out, or purchase, some other remembrance for Agnes; and, with a little alteration, do you not think, my sweet girl, that this work will do nicely for the inner curtains and veil?"

"A thousand times better than mine could have done!" exclaimed Dora, darting a glance of almost fierce dislike at the embroidery, now stained and marred, which she had once surveyed with such proud admiration.

"No, indeed," said Miss Clare, very kindly; "for though the Indian scarf may be—certainly is in itself more beautiful than your curtains, we cannot see in it the same token of patient perseverance in making what was intended to be an humble offering of love to the Lord."

"Oh, Aunt Theodora, I can stand this no longer!" exclaimed Dora, almost choking with the violence of her emotion. "You must know all, I can hide it no more; you must hear what a naughty, naughty girl I have been!"

Then, as well as she could through her tears and sobs, Dora relieved herself of the burden of concealment which had become at last intolerable. She told everything to her aunt—the first fault, the breaking of the fourth commandment; then the falsehood, the deceit which had followed, for when did an unrepented sin ever stand alone?

Dora concluded by passionately exclaiming, "You cannot, you must not, give me the brooch—Agnes has deserved it much better; she has been conquering her temper and doing all that she can to please mamma, while I have been only a hypocrite! Please give the brooch to Agnes, and the scarf for the model; I could not bear now to take either—I who have only deserved to be punished!"

Miss Clare was surprised, pained, disappointed by what she now heard; yet there was comfort to her in seeing that now at least her poor niece was heartily repenting.

"I cannot tell you, my child, how thankful I am that this accident has happened to your work, and that you have been led to speak out bravely at last," said her godmother, putting her arm round Dora, and drawing her tenderly towards her, so that the poor girl could weep on her bosom.

"Then you don't despise me—you won't give me up?" murmured Dora, crying still, but much more softly.

"Give you up—never!" cried her aunt, and she pressed a kiss upon Dora's brow. "It may be a question, indeed, whether I had not better reserve the brooch till next birthday."

"Oh, I never could take it, never!" cried Dora. "Let it be given to Agnes."

"Do you think, Dora, that by giving up the brooch you are winning a claim to forgiveness—that by this sacrifice you are atoning for what you have done wrong?" asked Miss Clare. "If so, I am bound to tell you that you are mistaken."

"No, aunt," replied Dora, for the first time raising her eyes, heavy with weeping, and looking her godmother full in the face; "I know that nothing that I can do can atone for my sin—that there is but one Atonement; but I feel as if I could not take the brooch which you meant to give to a good girl, and which I have so little—" Dora could not finish the sentence, tears came again, and she hid her face on the bosom of her aunt.

Miss Clare hesitated no longer. She felt that it would deeply impress on Dora's mind the painful lesson which she was learning if she saw the brooch in the possession of her older twin. What Miss Clare had heard from Mrs. Temple of the marked improvement in the character of Agnes convinced her that she was the sister who best deserved to receive the miniature of her mother. Miss Clare made a sacrifice of her own inclination in thus deciding to follow her

judgment, but she was in the habit of doing what she thought right, instead of what she thought pleasant.

"I will confess all to mamma, now, just as I have done to you—I won't be a hypocrite any longer," murmured Dora, as soon as she recovered the power to speak.

"And there is Another to whom my child must also confess," said Miss Clare, still with her arm round her niece, still with Dora's head on her breast; "there is One who is ready freely to forgive every penitent who approaches the Mercy-seat pleading the merits of Christ. We have no power to remove one spot from our souls—" the eyes of Miss Clare chanced to rest, as she spoke, on the embroidery, stained and destroyed—"but there is the Lord's promise to comfort the broken and contrite heart,—

> "'...though your sins be as scarlet, they shall be white as snow; though they be red as crimson, they shall be as wool.'"

Dora and her godmother knelt down together, and together prayed, but in silence. When they rose from their knees, though Dora was still very sad and subdued, there was a peace in her heart, and a sense of sin forgiven, which she had not experienced for months.

CHAPTER XXI

CONCLUSION

"DORA is late—shockingly late—on her birthday, too! I 'am' surprised!" exclaimed Elsie, who was in a fidget of impatience to present her sister with a marker which she had made.

"And aunt has kept us twenty—more than twenty minutes waiting for prayers!" cried Amy. "I am surprised, for she always is so punctual."

"And Agnes has employed the time mending my gloves, the most surprising thing of all," laughed Lucius.

"Why so surprising?" asked Elsie.

"Because a few months ago Agnes was much more given to picking holes than to sewing them up," answered the boy. "I liked to plague her and she to tease me, and I thought that we should always live a kind of cat-and-dog life together. But now we're going to be grand allies," added the merry boy, clapping Agnes upon the shoulder; "by your example, you'll help to mend my manners as well as my gloves!"

Lucius spoke in his saucy, playful way; but "there's many a true word spoken in jest," and he was but expressing what all the family had observed, that there was gradual but steady improvement in the outer conduct of the once peevish and selfish girl.

But the sharpest conflict of Agnes upon her twelfth birthday had been against a jealous spirit within. From a few words dropped by her aunt on the previous evening, Agnes felt sure that her mother's likeness would be given

as a birthday present to one of the twins, and she had not a doubt that the younger would be the one thus favoured.

"It was just the same last birthday," thought Agnes, with bitterness; "I am given some makeshift, Dora has what is really of value. It is rather hard that she should always be preferred before her elder sister because she is called after my aunt, whilst I am named after my mother. But oh! How wicked is this feeling of jealousy, how sinful these unkind and covetous thoughts! Lord! Help me to overcome this secret temptation, and to feel pleasure, real pleasure, when I see Dora wearing that which is so precious to us both!"

As the thought, or rather the prayer, passed through the mind of Agnes, the door opened and Miss Clare entered, followed by Dora. Their aunt held the beautiful brooch in her hand, and going up to the elder twin, whom she had not met before that morning, with a kiss and a whispered blessing, fastened the precious jewel in her dress.

That twenty-fourth day of December was a day long remembered with delight by many a poor child in Chester, for large was the number of scholars (it would be scarcely just to call them ragged) who enjoyed the feast, the Christmas-tree, and the varied amusements provided for them in the large red house by their benefactress, Miss Clare.

Specially was the beautiful, the wonderful model which the young gentlefolk had made the theme of many a conversation in the low courts and lanes from which the guests had been gathered. Worn, weary mothers, at their

sewing or washing, paused, needle in hand, or with arms whitened with soap-suds, to hear of the golden pillars and silver loops, and above all of the splendid embroidery that adorned the inner part of the model, that part which, as Miss Clare had told them, was the Holy of holies.

"And the young ladies looked just as pleased and happy as we," a bare-footed little urchin observed at the end of a lively narration of all the wonders that he had seen; "all but one, and her eyes were red as if she'd been a-crying,—what could 'she' have had to make her cry? But she smiled, too, when we clapped our hands and shouted for joy as we saw the beautiful tent!"

What delighted their eyes and pleased their fancy was what naturally made the greatest impression on the ragged scholars who had stared in wondering admiration on the model of the Tabernacle of Israel. But the concluding words of a little address made by Miss Clare to the children were what sank deepest into the memories and the hearts of her twin nieces.

"I have described to you, my dear young pupils, the various parts of this model," she said; "let me now briefly point out a few lessons which we should all carry away. In Israel's Tabernacle we see a TYPE of every Christian, in whose body, as St. Paul tells us, God's Holy Spirit deigns to dwell. In that living Tabernacle, the lowly heart is the Holy of holies, because it is cleansed by the blood of sprinkling; in it the Commandments of God are treasured, and the light of His love shines within. But, as the Tabernacle was not intended to last for ever, but to give place to a far more splendid building, so it is with these bodies of ours.

"As Solomon's magnificent temple, glorious and fair, and firm on its deep foundation, far surpassed the

Tabernacle made to be moved from place to place; so the glorified bodies of saints when they are raised from their graves will surpass these weak, mortal bodies in which they served their Lord upon earth. For what saith the Apostle St. Paul:

> "'WE KNOW THAT IF OUR EARTHLY HOUSE OF THIS TABERNACLE WERE DISSOLVED, WE HAVE A BUILDING OF GOD, A HOUSE NOT MADE WITH HANDS, ETERNAL IN THE HEAVENS.'"

THE END.

*** END OF THE INFINIDIGITAL EBOOK DORA'S MISTAKE ***

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